Chapter 25 - Stage 7 of SKDL -- Executable Knowledge (Part 2): Value Specification & Precise Binding

The Second Layer of Executability

Chapter 24 built the *boundary layer* of an executable ontology: universal restrictions defines what was allowed, and closure axioms closed the world around those boundaries. The ontology could classify a pizza as `VegetarianPizza` deterministically, without ambiguity.

But a boundary tells the system what is *permitted*. It does not tell the system what to *do*.

Consider a pizza that is `Hot`, an order whose status is `Pending`, or a customer whose tier is `Gold`. Each of these is a **specific value** -- not a range, not a category, but one point in a closed set. Execution often fires on exactly these points: *"If the spiciness is `Hot`, alert the kitchen. If the order is `Pending`, send a reminder. If the tier is `Gold`, apply the discount."*

Chapter 25 builds the layer that makes these triggers possible: the **value layer**. It has two halves. An **enumerated class** closes the *value domain* -- it declares the complete, finite set of values a property may take (`Spiciness = {Hot, Medium, Mild}`). A **`hasValue` restriction** binds a property to *one specific value* from that domain (`JalapenoPepperTopping hasSpiciness value Hot`). Together, they allow the ontology to express and execute rules that depend on *specific values* rather than *categories*. This is the semantic foundation of the trigger.

This chapter follows **Exercise 24** and **Exercise 25** in Michael DeBellis' *Protégé 5 New OWL Pizza Tutorial*, read through the lens of executability. It is the second of three chapters on **Stage 7 -- Executable Knowledge**.

Key Insight:

> "A boundary tells the system what is allowed. A value tells the system what to act on. The value layer is where execution becomes specific."

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25.1 Chapter Introduction

In **Chapter 24**, we built the first layer of an executable ontology: the **boundary layer**. Universal restrictions told the reasoner what was allowed; closure axioms closed the world around those boundaries. By the end of that chapter, the ontology could classify `MargheritaPizza` and `SohoPizza` as `VegetarianPizza` -- deterministically and without ambiguity.

But a boundary tells the system what is *permitted*; it does not tell the system what to *do*.

Consider a pizza that is `Hot`. Or an order whose status is `Pending`. Or a customer whose tier is `Gold`. Each of these is a specific value -- not a boundary, not a range, but one point in a closed set. Execution often fires on exactly these points. "If the spiciness is `Hot`, alert the kitchen. If the order is `Pending`, send a reminder. If the tier is `Gold`, apply the discount."

Chapter 25 builds the layer that makes these triggers possible: the **value layer**.

The value layer has two halves:

- An **enumerated class** closes the *value domain* -- it declares the complete, finite set of values a property may take. `Spiciness = {Hot, Medium, Mild}`. No other value is possible.
- A `hasValue` **restriction** binds a property to *one specific value* from that domain. `JalapenoPepperTopping hasSpiciness value Hot`. Not a class of values -- the value itself.

Together, they allow the ontology to express and execute rules that depend on *specific values* rather than *categories*. This is the semantic foundation of the trigger.

This chapter follows **Exercise 24** and **Exercise 25** in Michael DeBellis' *Protégé 5 New OWL Pizza Tutorial*, read through the lens of executability. It is the second of three chapters on **Stage 7 -- Executable Knowledge**.

Key Insight:

> "A boundary tells the system what is allowed. A value tells the system what to act on. The value layer is where execution becomes specific."

25.1.1 How Chapter 25 Continues Chapter 24

Chapter 24 built the boundary layer from two primitives: the universal restriction (**Exercise 22**) and the closure axiom (**Exercise 23**). Chapter 25 builds the value layer from two more: the enumerated class (**Exercise 24**) and the `hasValue` restriction (**Exercise 25**).

Layer	Primitive	Exercise	What It Closes
Boundary	Universal Restriction (`only`)	Ex 22	What is permitted
Boundary	Closure Axiom	Ex 23	What exhaustively exists
Value	Enumerated Class	Ex 24	The set of possible values
Value	`hasValue` Restriction	Ex 25	The specific value to act on
Integrity	Cardinality Restriction	Ex 26 (Ch 26)	The number of values required

Each layer depends on the one before it. The value layer is meaningless without the boundary layer -- binding a value to a property whose permitted range is not closed would leave the binding ambiguous. Conversely, the boundary layer is incomplete without the value layer -- a boundary that cannot fire on specific values cannot drive action.

Key Insight:

> "The boundary layer says what is closed. The value layer says what to fire on. Execution needs both."

25.2 Learning Objectives

After completing this chapter, you should be able to achieve the following learning outcomes:

Knowledge:

- Explain why the value layer is the second layer of executable knowledge
- Distinguish between a *closed value domain* and a *specific value binding*
- Understand how enumerated classes differ from asserted class membership
- Understand how `hasValue` restrictions differ from `some` and `only` restrictions
- Explain why both primitives are required for value-based triggers

Practical Skills (Stage 7, Chapter 25):

- Create an enumerated class using `EquivalentTo {...}` in Protégé
- Create the individuals that populate an enumerated class
- Create an object property with a defined domain and range
- Add a `hasValue` restriction to a class
- Define a class using a nested restriction (`some` containing `value`)
- Convert a class to a defined class
- Test value-based classification by synchronizing the reasoner

Mathematical Perspective:

- Understand enumeration as the finite specification of a class extension: $C \equiv \{a_1, \ldots, a_n\}$
- Understand `hasValue` as a restriction whose filler is an individual, not a class: $p \text{ value } a$
- Explain the composition of `some` and `value` as a nested restriction: $\exists p.(\exists q.\{a\})$
- Understand the relationship between enumeration, closure, and exhaustiveness

Engineering Perspective:

- Understand the value layer as the semantic foundation of triggers
- Map the enumerated class to the concept of an `enum` in programming
- Map the `hasValue` restriction to the concept of a state-machine transition condition
- Apply the two primitives to industrial scenarios (alerting, workflow routing, decision tables)

> **Note on scope.**
>
> These learning objectives are scoped to **Chapter 25**. Chapter 26 will add cardinality restrictions and the consolidated Stage 7 architecture. Chapter 24 (already covered) introduced the boundary layer.

25.3 A Brief Note on OWL Design Patterns

Before we build our next execution primitive, it is worth pausing to name a concept that has quietly been present throughout this book: **the design pattern**.

The idea of a design pattern comes originally from architecture -- Christopher Alexander's *A Pattern Language* (1977) -- and was brought into software engineering by the "Gang of Four" in their 1994 book *Design Patterns*.

> **Alexander's insight** was that good design does not begin from nothing; it draws on a shared vocabulary of proven solutions to recurring problems. Each solution can be adapted to a specific context without being reinvented.

In OWL, the same idea applies. A **design pattern** is a reusable combination of OWL constructs that solves a recurring modeling problem. It sits at a higher level of abstraction than a single class or axiom -- it is a **shape**, not a thing!

By this point in the book, you have already used several OWL design patterns without necessarily calling them that:

Pattern	Introduced	Purpose
Probe Class	Chapter 22 (Exercise 19)	A deliberately inconsistent class used to test whether validation infrastructure works
Closure Axiom	Chapter 24 (Exercise 23)	A universal restriction that closes the world for a class or individual
Enumerated Class	This chapter (Exercise 24)	A class whose extension is defined by listing all of its instances
`hasValue` **Restriction**	This chapter (Exercise 25)	A restriction that binds a property to a specific individual
Cardinality Restriction	Chapter 26 (Exercise 26, upcoming)	A restriction on the number of values a property may have

Each of these is a **reusable shape**, not a one-off modeling decision. You can apply the same shape to any class in any domain -- pizza, manufacturing, financing, healthcare -- and it will work the same way.

That reusability is what makes design patterns valuable for governance and execution:

- **Reuse**: A pattern written once can be instantiated many times.
- **Consistency**: Different engineers applying the same pattern produce structurally similar (or even same) models.
- **Governance**: Patterns can be named, documented, and governed like any other asset.
- **Execution**: The execution primitives in this chapter (closure, enumeration, `hasValue`, cardinality) are effectively the design patterns of Stage 7.

The full OWL design pattern landscape -- the ODP catalog, logical vs. content patterns, pattern composition, and pattern selection strategies -- is a topic of its own. It belongs to the era of **Knowledge Graph Engineering**, when you are building systems that span multiple ontologies and reuse libraries of proven patterns.

> **Note**
>
> **About the ODP catalog.** The Ontology Design Patterns (ODP) catalog is maintained by the Ontology Design Patterns Association (ODPA) at `ontologydesignpatterns.org`. At the time of writing, the site is served over HTTP and must be accessed via its full wiki path — the bare host may time out depending on the network.
>
> If you want to access the catalog, here is the direct URL: http://www.ontologydesignpatterns.org/index.php/Ontology_Design_Patterns_._org_(ODP) -- available at the date of this note.
>
> *-- Note at 2026-10-03*

We will return to it in **Volume 5**.

For now, the key point is this:

> **When you build an execution primitive in this chapter, you are not just writing an axiom -- you are instantiating a design pattern.**

The patterns will grow with you as your ontology grows.

25.4 Exercise 24 -- Enumerated Classes and Deterministic Value Sets

Having established closure axioms in **Exercise 23**, we now turn to the first execution primitive of the **value layer**: the enumerated class.

As we saw in **§24.6.7**, the enumerated class is one of the design patterns of Stage 7 — here we instantiate it.

25.4.1 The Engineering Objective

Exercise 24 introduces the **enumerated class** -- a class whose extension is defined by explicitly listing all of its instances.

An enumerated class for spiciness, for example, would be:

```
Class: Spiciness
  EquivalentTo: {Hot, Medium, Mild}
```

This means: "The class `Spiciness` has exactly three instances: `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild`."

The engineering objective for **Exercise 24** is to demonstrate how enumeration provides a **complete, deterministic value domain** -- a prerequisite for execution.

Why does execution need enumeration?

Consider an execution rule that fires when a pizza is "spicy". For the rule to be reliable, the system must know the complete set of possible spiciness values. If the ontology only says "there exists a `Spiciness` value" but does not enumerate what that value could be, the rule cannot be exhaustively evaluated.

Enumeration closes the value domain. It says: *these are all the possible values -- nothing more, nothing less.*

This is the value-domain analogue of the closure axiom. The closure axiom closed the set of permitted *toppings* for a class; the enumerated class closes the set of permitted *values* for a property. Both replace an open-world description with a closed-world specification -- one at the property-range level, one at the value level. Together, they are the two halves of boundary closure.

Key Insight:

> "An enumerated class is a closed-world specification of a value domain. It says not just what values exist, but that **no other values exist**."

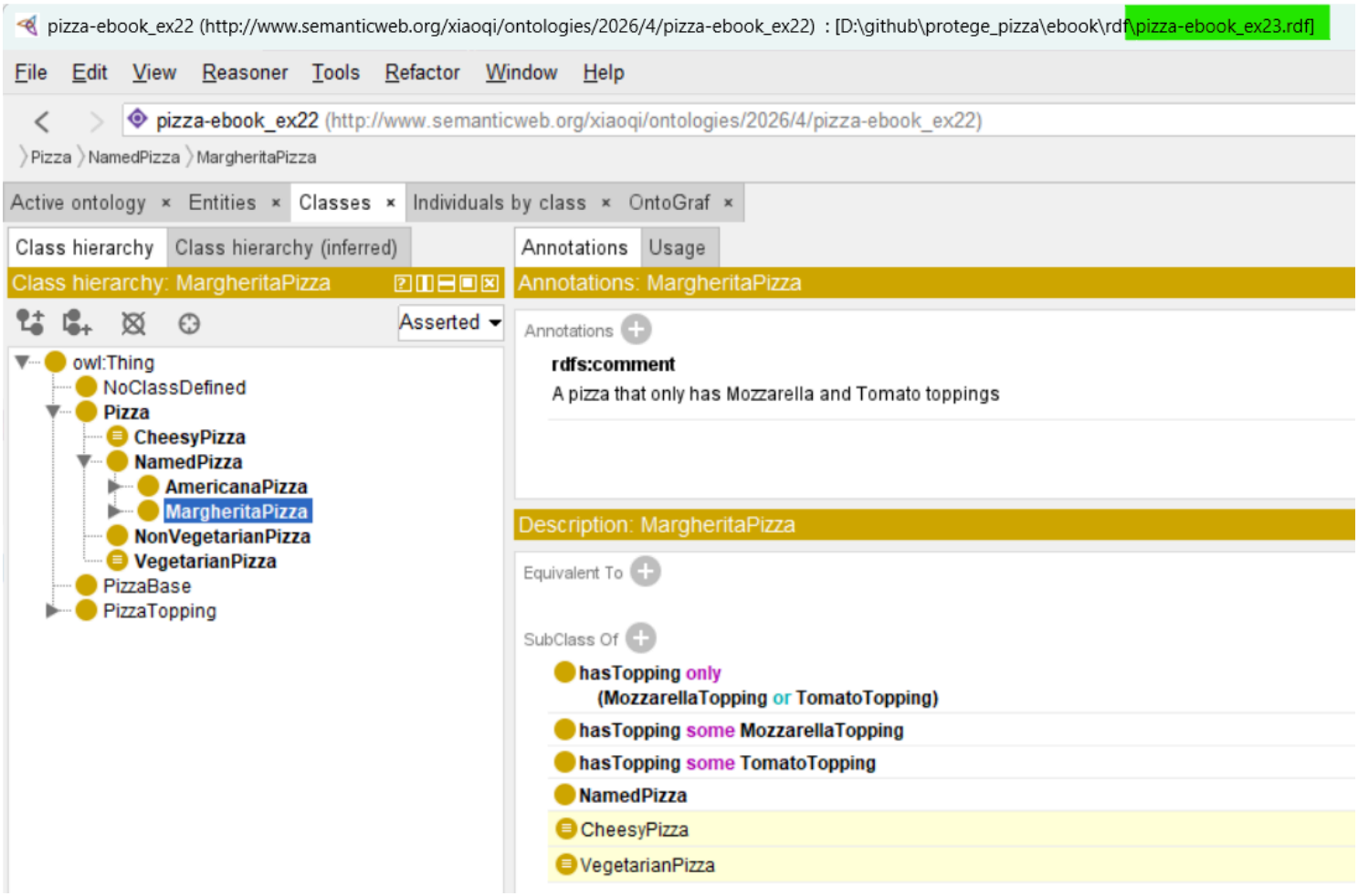
25.4.2 Implementation: Creating the Enumerated Class

Let's walk through the implementation step by step.

As you'll see, the workflow is slightly different from **Exercises 22 and 23** -- enumerated classes are created by combining three OWL constructs: a class, its three instances, and an `EquivalentTo` axiom that lists them.

Step 1: Open the `Pizza` ontology

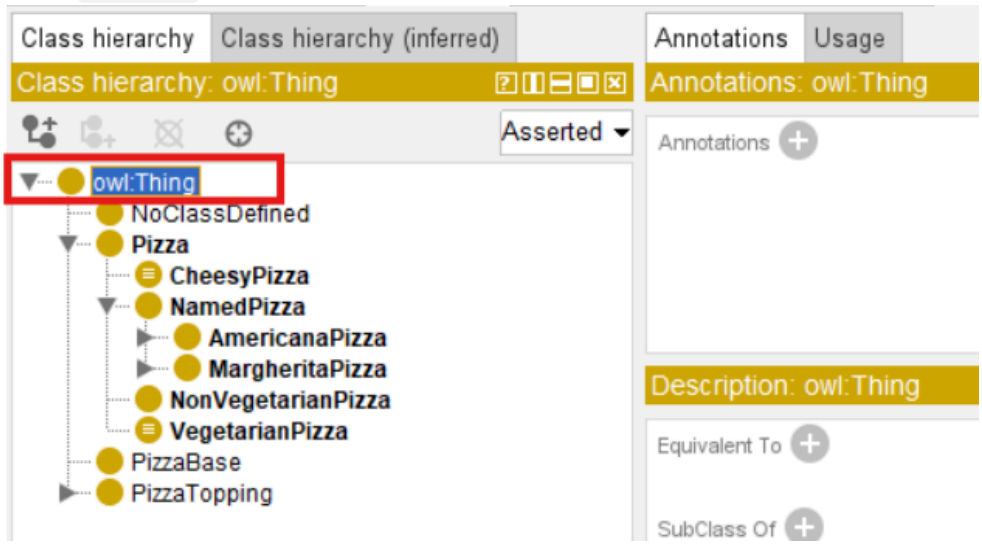
Open `pizza-ebook_ex23.rdf` in Protégé - the file from the previous exercise, which now contains closure axioms on `MargheritaPizza` and `SohoPizza`, and the individual-level closure on `TestVegetarianPizza`.



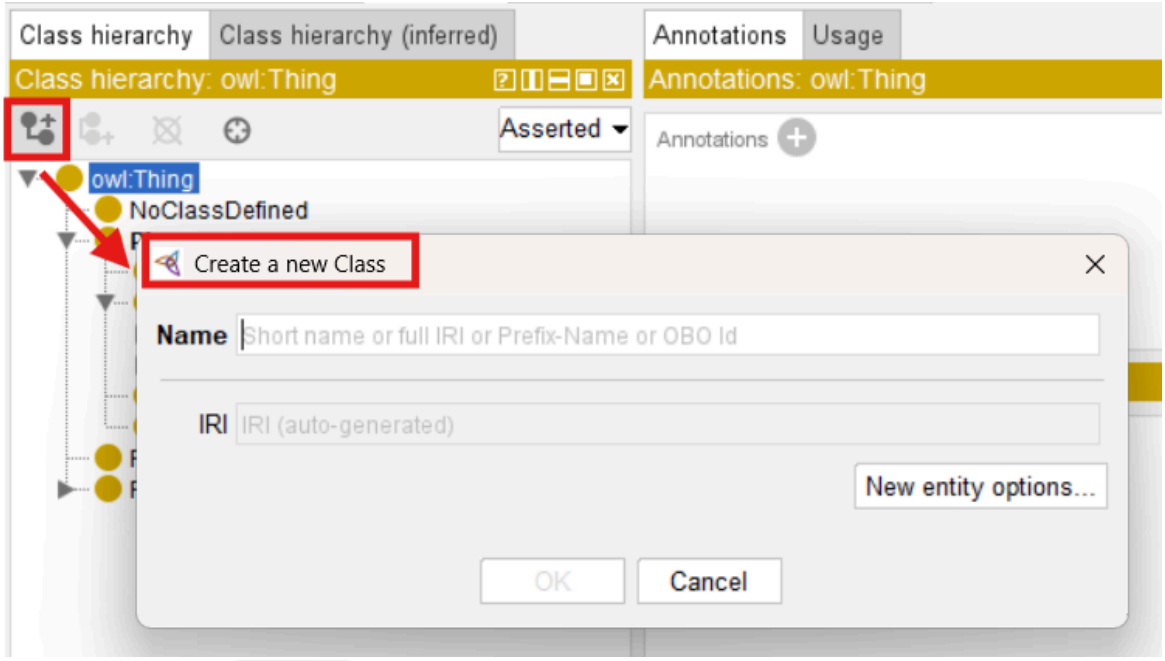
> **Note**
>
> The finished state of **Exercise 24** is saved as `pizza-ebook_ex24.rdf`.

Step 2: Create the `Spiciness` class

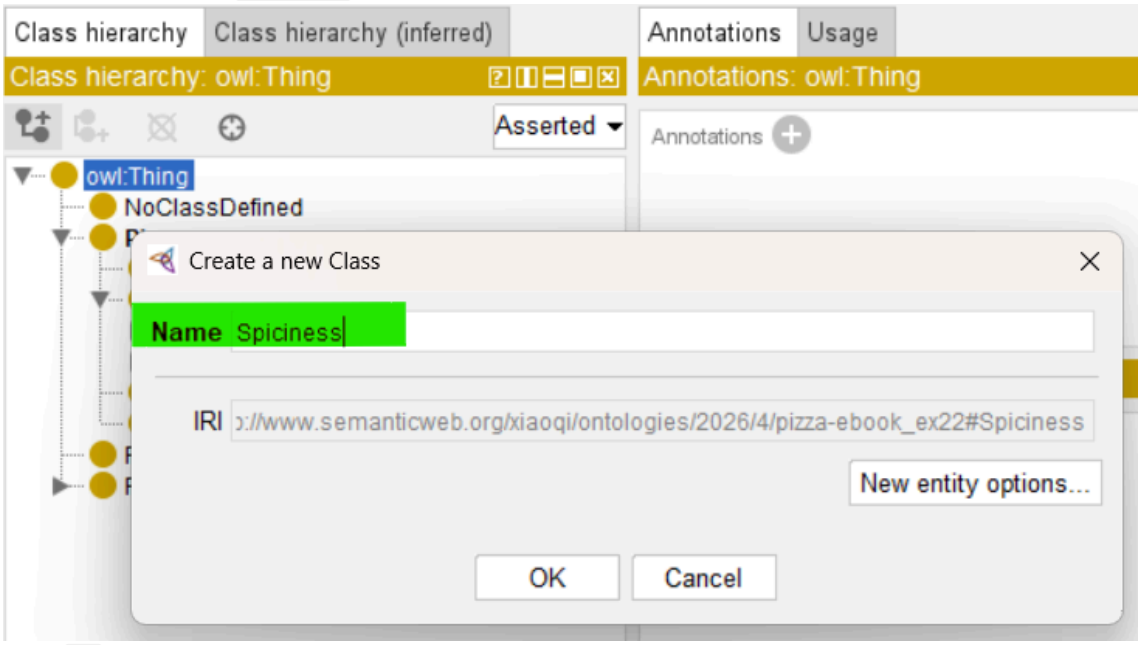
1. Navigate to the Classes tab. (You may already at this tab)
2. Select `owl:Thing` in the class hierarchy



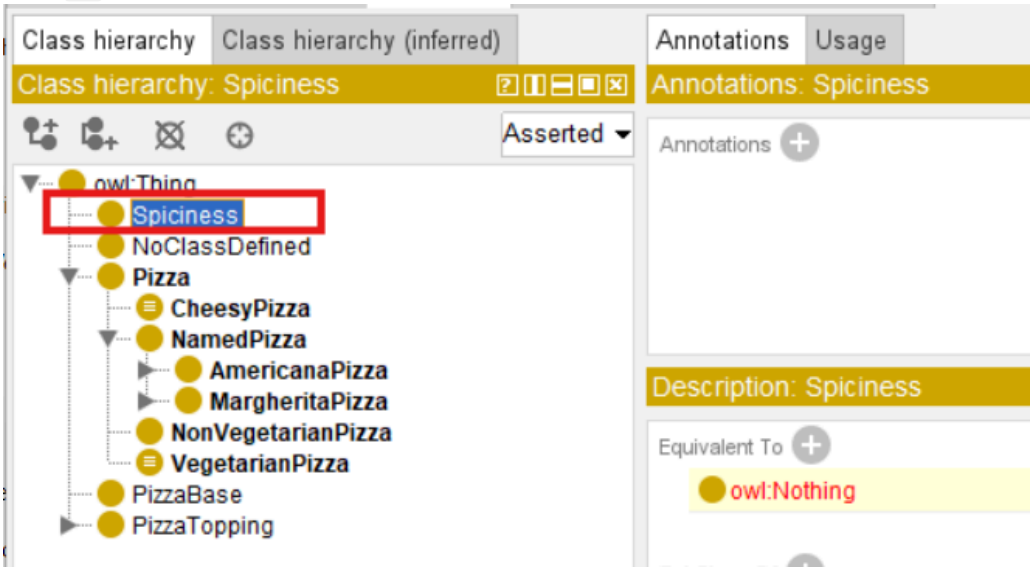
3. Click the **Add subclass** icon.



4. Name the new class `Spiciness`



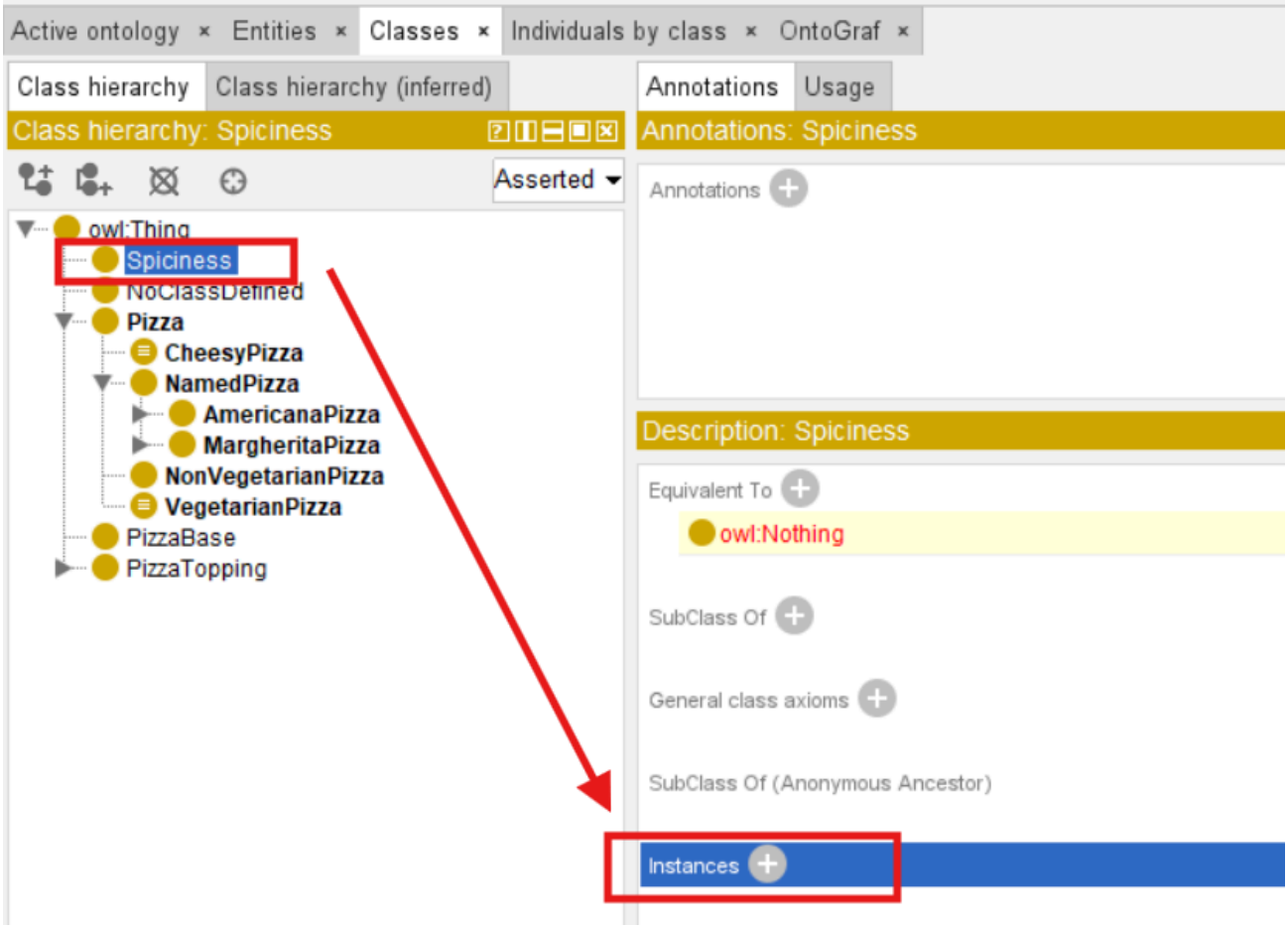
5. Click `OK`



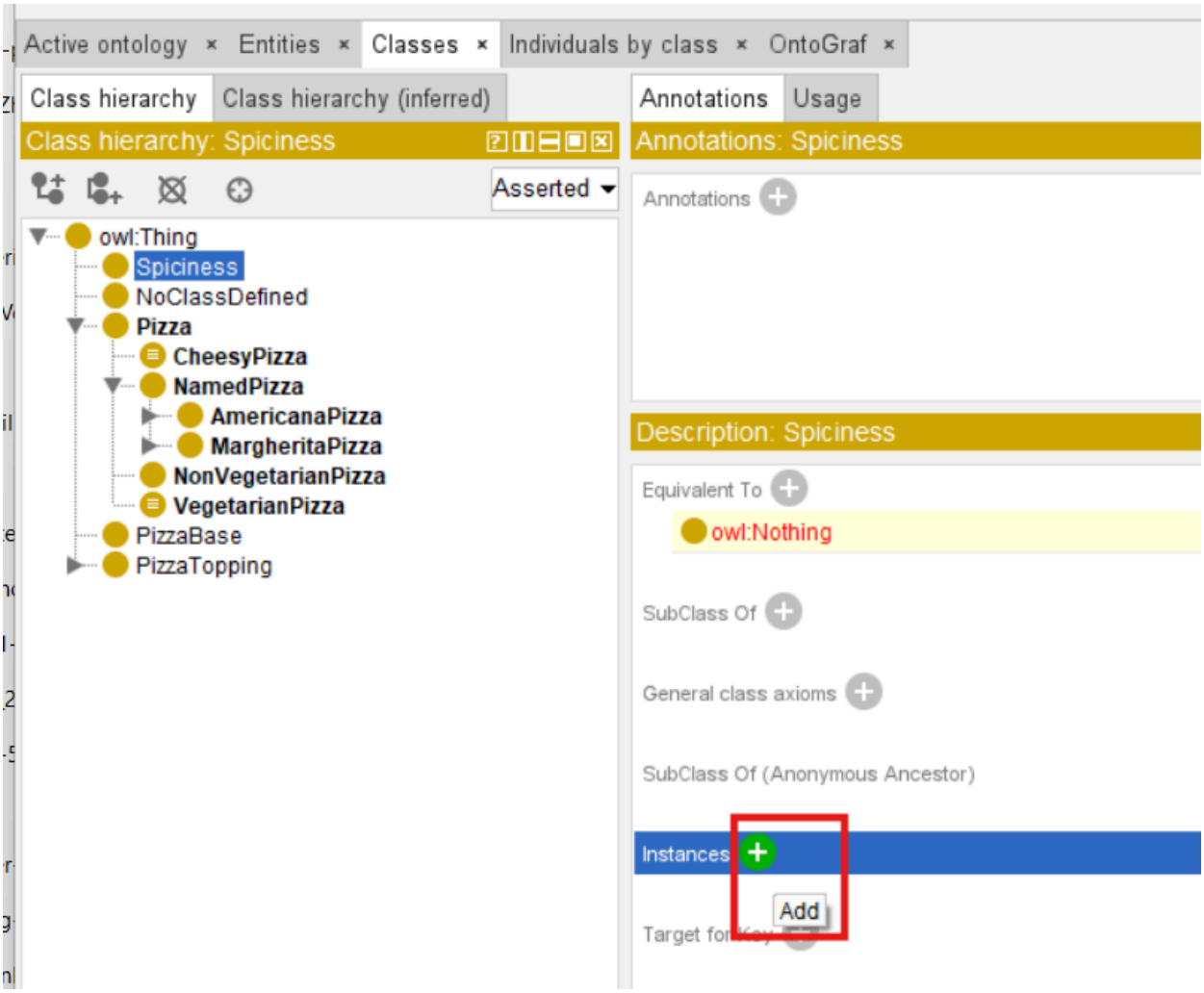
At this point, `Spiciness` is an empty class -- a class with no instances and no definition. We will now give it both.

Step 3: Create the individuals for the enumerated class

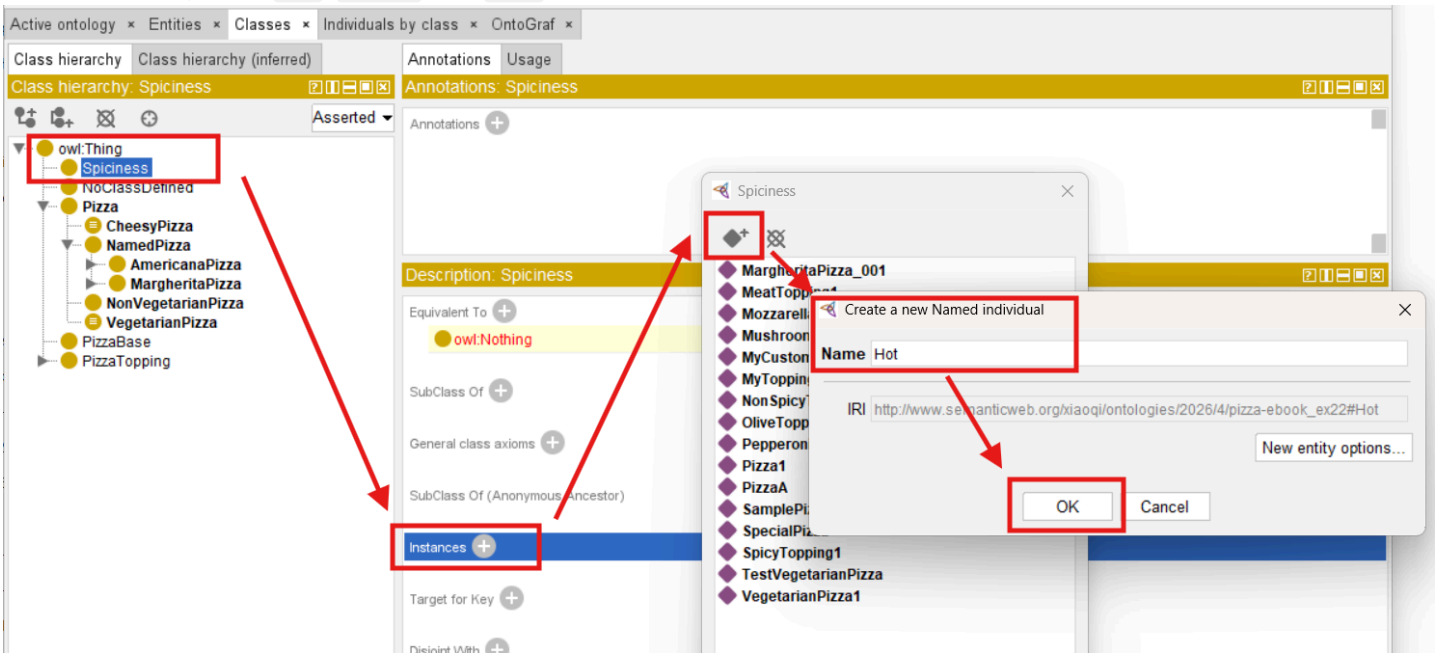
1. In the Classes tab, make sure `Spiciness` is selected. (After above Step2.5, the cursor should be by default on `Spiciness`.)
2. In the Description view, locate the `Instances` section near the bottom. (You may also switch to **Individuals by class** tab)



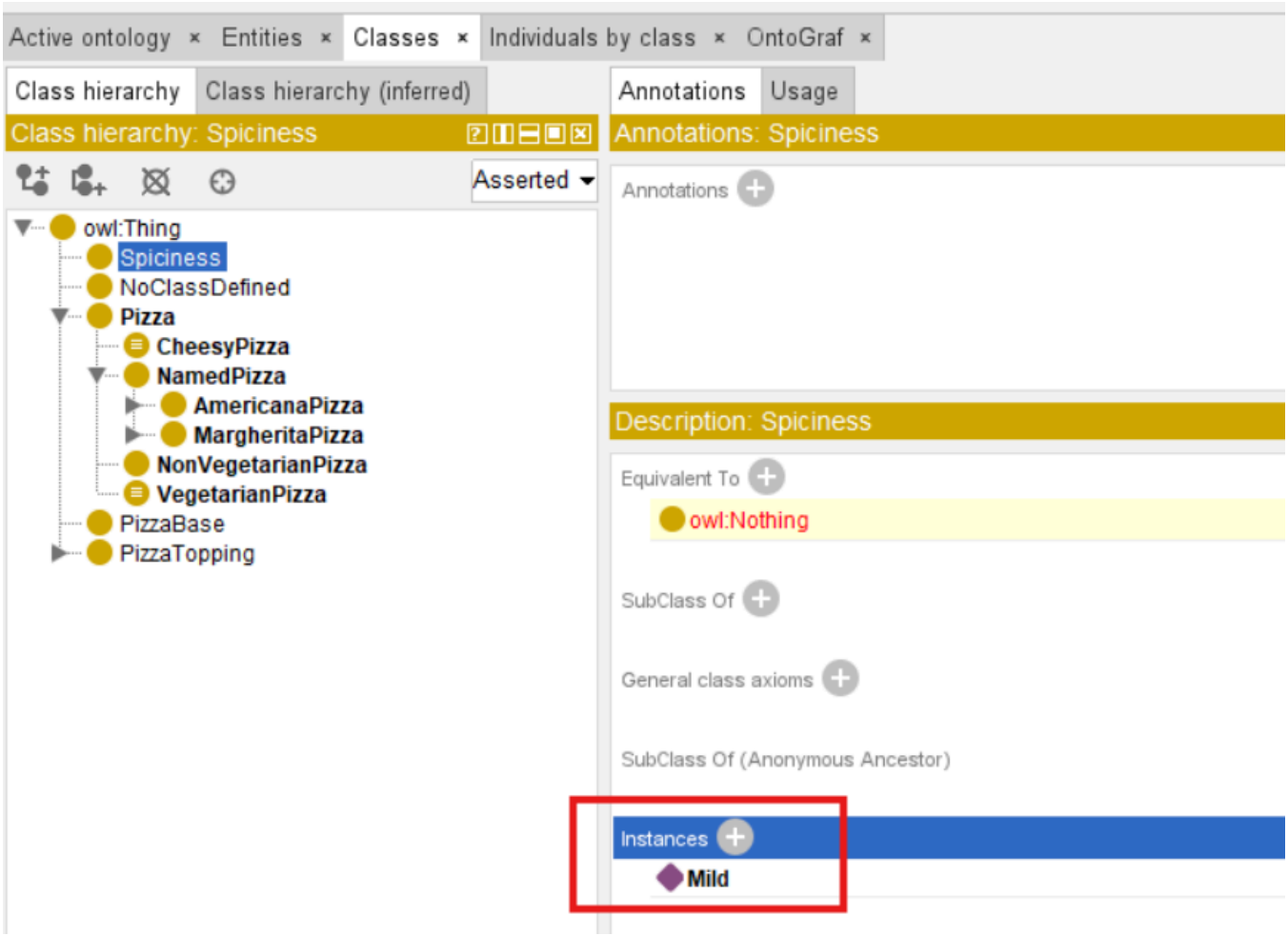
3. Click the Add icon (+) next to **Instances**



4. A dialog will appear with a diamond icon (create new individual) and a delete icon. Use the diamond icon to create three individuals in sequence: `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild`.

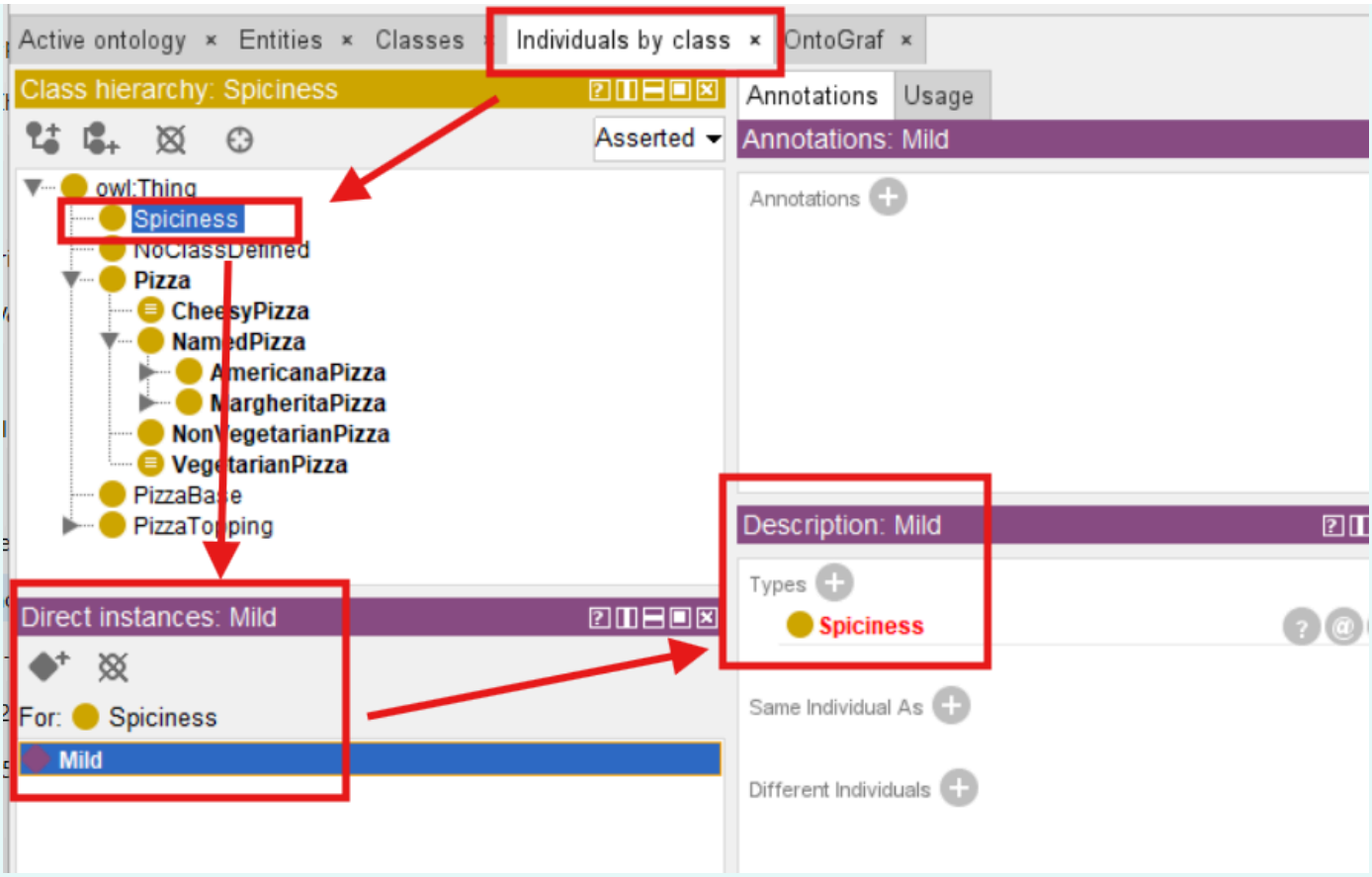


5. After creating, your `Spiciness` class' individuals should be like below:



Tip

You may also use **Individuals by class** tab to create those individuals, below is the screen of the three individuals after creating:

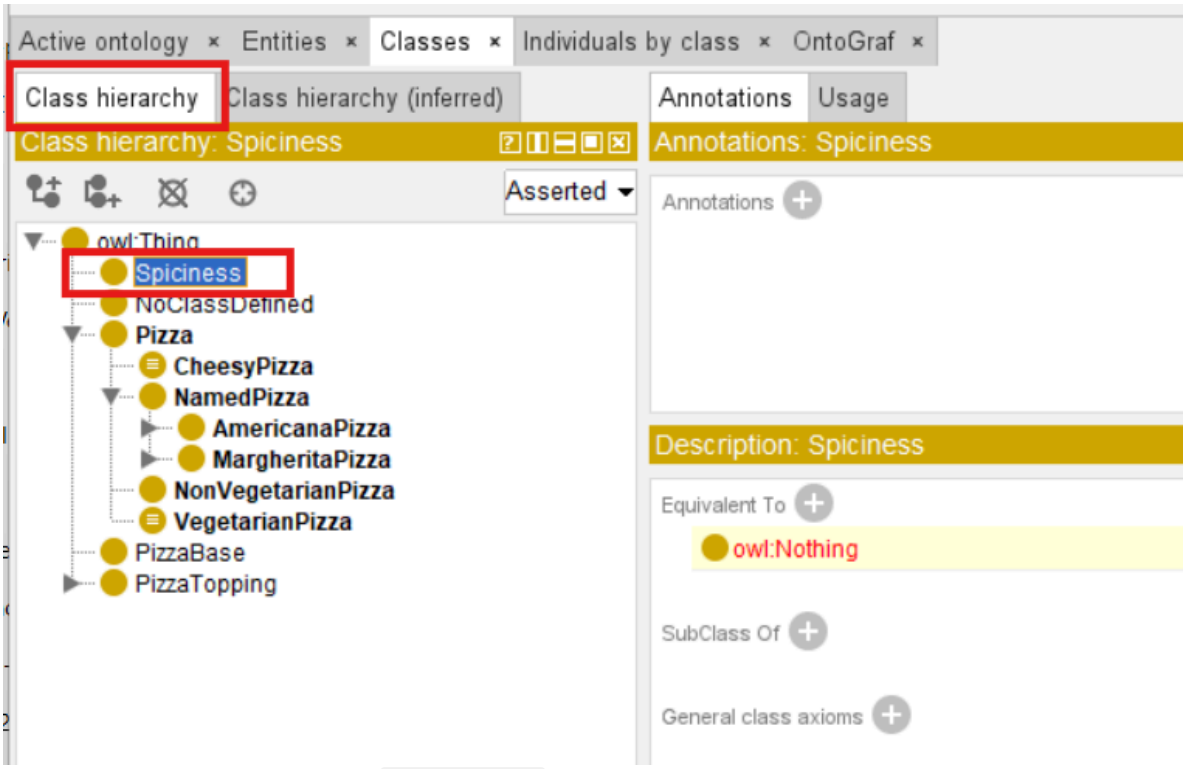


Choose either way which you are preferred.

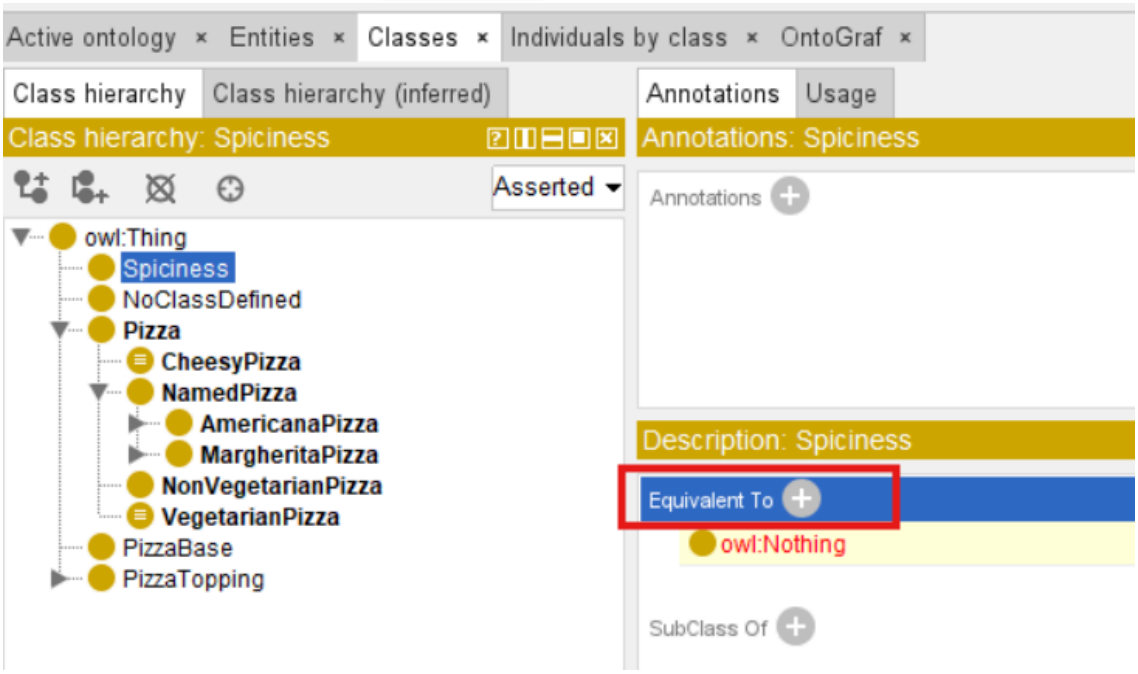
> **Note**
>
> You may notice that only one of the three new individuals is actually created as an instance of `Spiciness` at this point. That is expected. The next step will supply the reasoner with enough information to recognize all three as instances of the class.

Step 4: Define `Spiciness` as an enumerated class

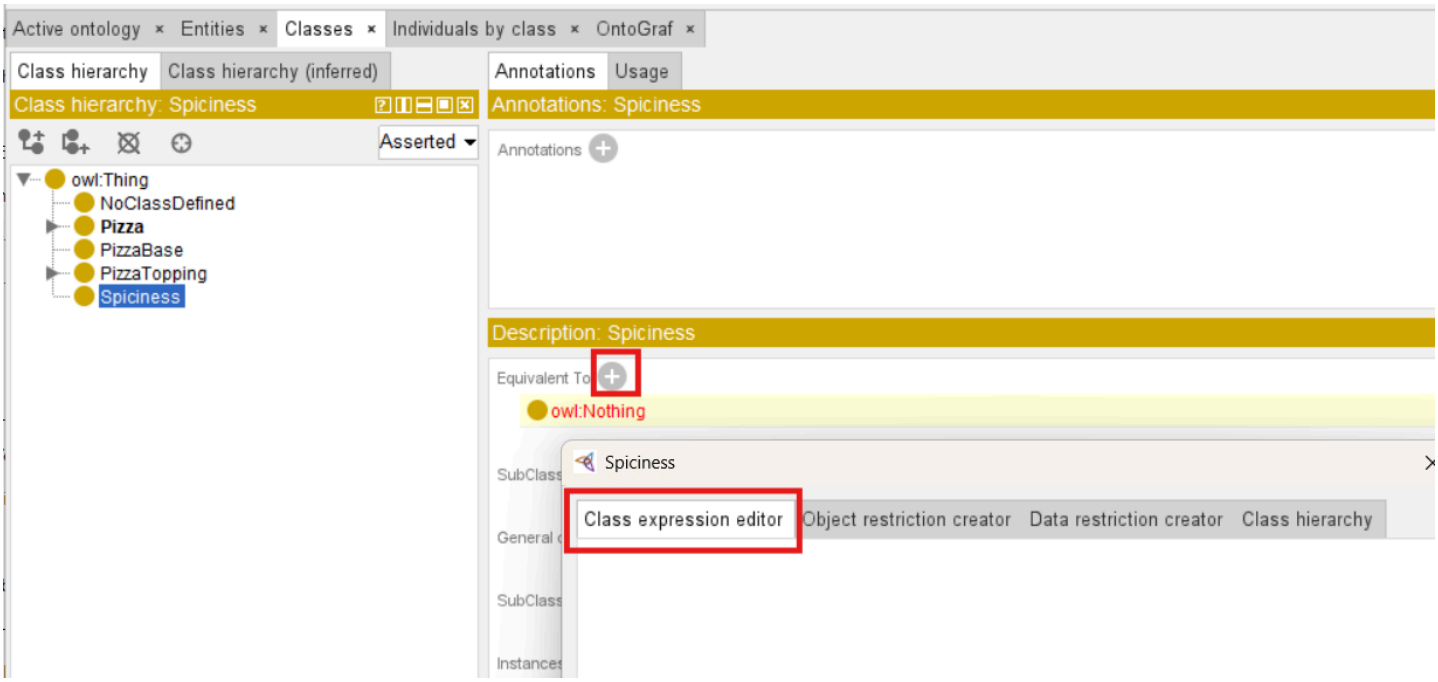
1. Make sure `Spiciness` is still selected



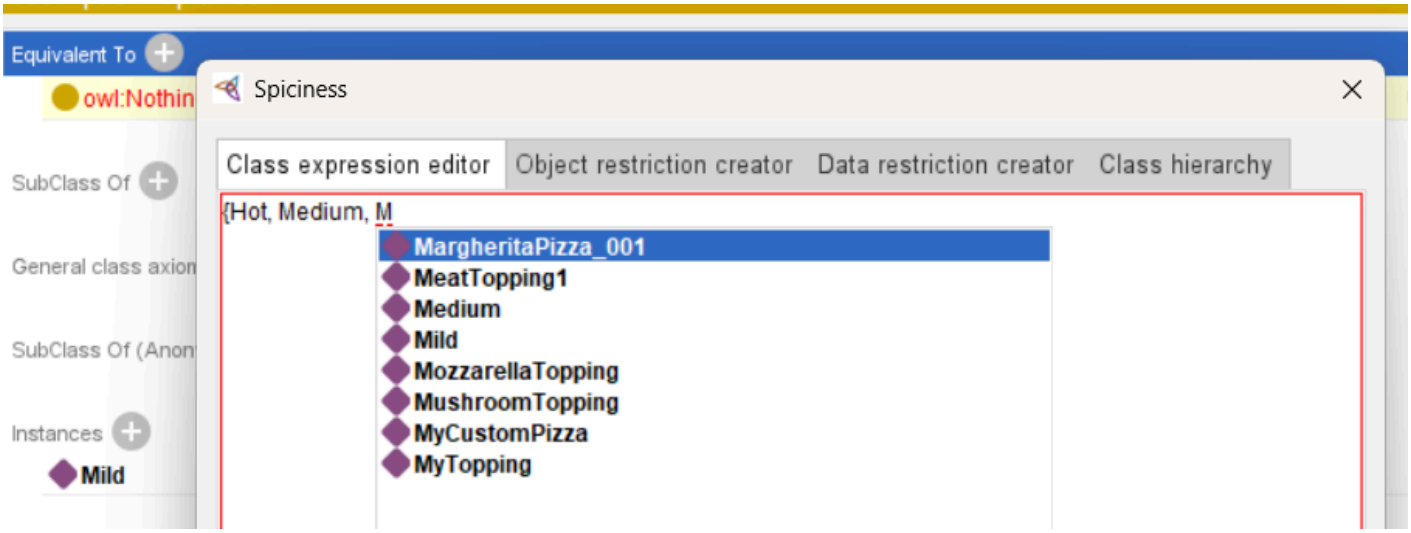
2. In the Description view, locate the `Equivalent To` section.



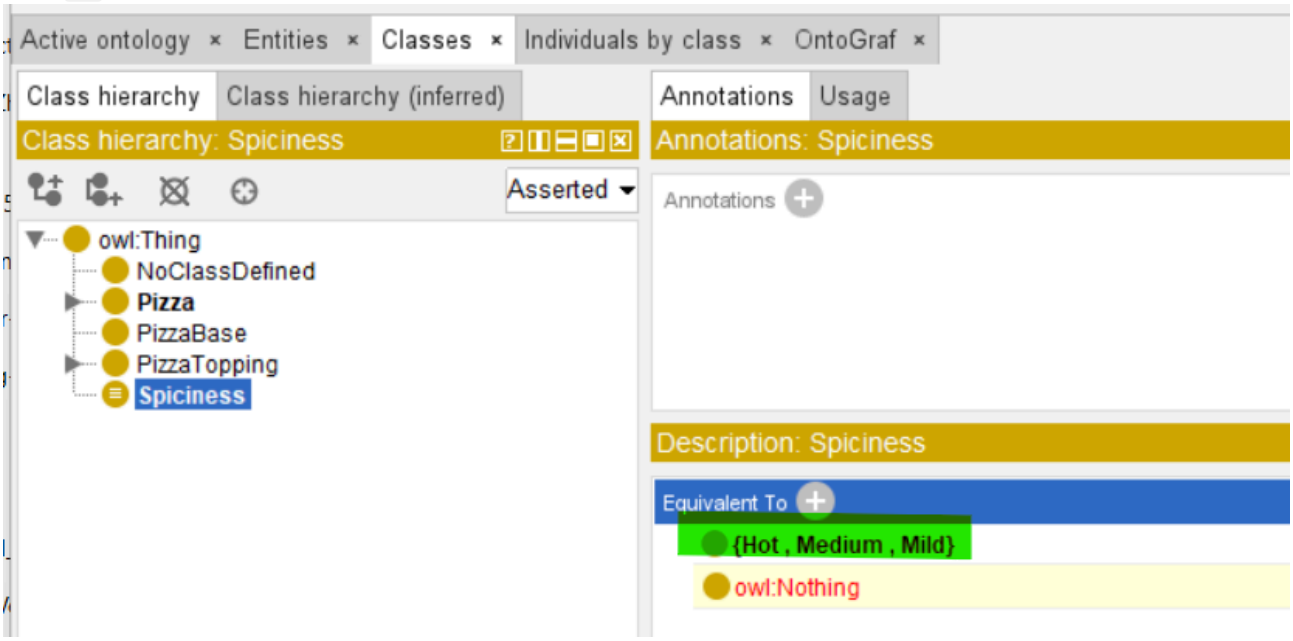
3. Click the Add icon (+)



4. In the Class Expression Editor, enter: `{Hot, Medium, Mild}`. (Tip: remember you may click Tab while typing to get possible choices)



5. Click `OK`.

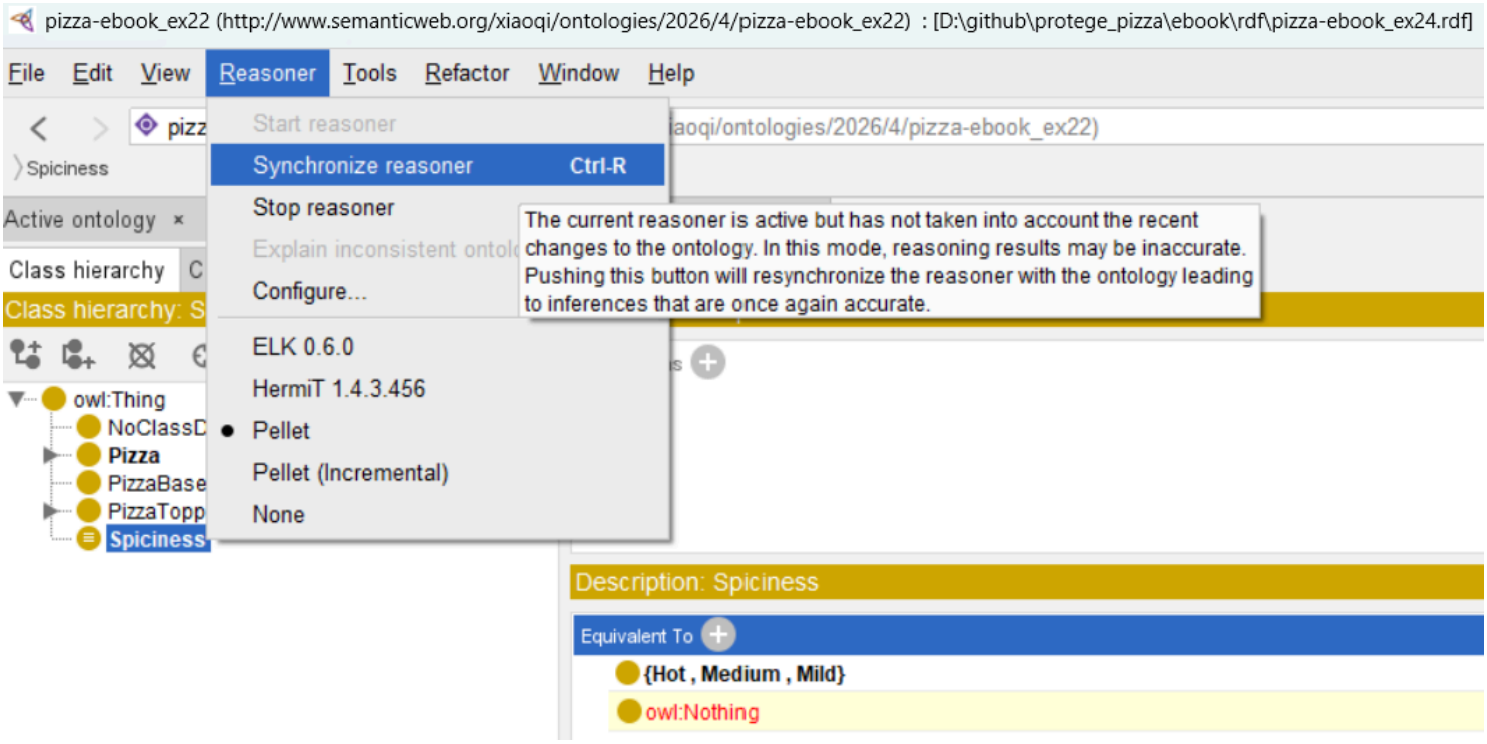


After this step, `Spiciness` class has the following description:

```
Class: Spiciness
  EquivalentTo: {Hot, Medium, Mild}
```

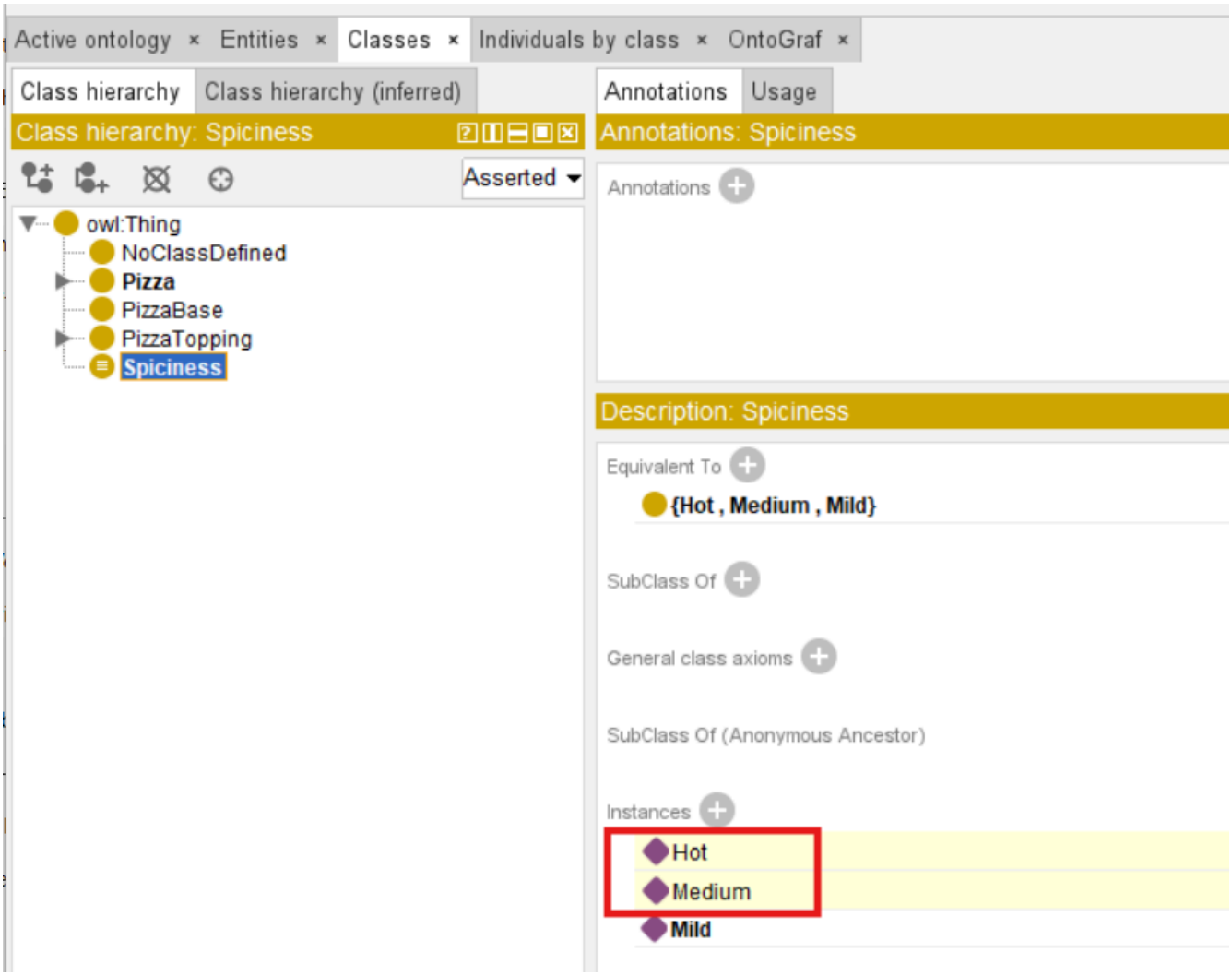
Step 5: Synchronize the reasoner

Select `Reasoner > Synchronize reasoner` (Ctrl+R)



Step 6: Observe the result

Look at `Spiciness` in the Classes tab.



The reasoner now recognizes `Spiciness` as a **defined class** (three horizontal stripes in the class icon), with exactly three instances: `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild`. No other individual can be an instance of `Spiciness`, because the class definition enumerates the complete set of allowed values.

The reasoner has done two things:

1. **Classified the three individuals as instances of** `Spiciness` -- even though we asserted only one of them directly, the enumeration definition now covers all three.
2. **Closed the value domain** -- the class `Spiciness` now has exactly three instances, and no more are possible.

This is the first time in the chapter that we have closed the world for *values* rather than for *properties*. The effect is immediate: what was previously an open-ended class with unknown membership is now a fully specified enumeration.

Key Insight:

> "Before the `EquivalentTo` axiom, `Spiciness` was an empty class -- a name without an extension. After the axiom, `Spiciness` has a complete, closed-world specification: exactly three values, and no others."

25.4.3 The Result: A Deterministic Value Domain

The enumerated class has provided a **deterministic value domain** for `Spiciness`.

For execution, this is essential. When an execution system encounters a `Spiciness` value, it knows the value must be one of `Hot`, `Medium`, or `Mild`. It can handle all possible cases exhaustively.

Contrast this with the alternative. If we had only declared `Spiciness` as a class (with `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild` as asserted instances), the reasoner would still recognize those three individuals as instances of `Spiciness`. But it would not know that they are the *only* instances. Under the Open World Assumption, there might be other spiciness values not yet asserted.

Enumeration removes this uncertainty. The `EquivalentTo {Hot, Medium, Mild}` axiom does two things simultaneously:

- It says that `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild` **are** instances of `Spiciness` (sufficient condition).
- It also says that anything else is **not** an instance of `Spiciness` (necessary condition).

This is what makes enumeration a closed-world specification.

Key Insight:

> "Enumerated classes are the OWL equivalent of an `enum` in a programming language. They define the complete set of possible values -- nothing more, nothing less."

25.4.4 Why Enumerated Classes Matter for Execution

Enumerated classes are essential for execution because:

1. **They define finite value domains.** Execution systems need to know the complete range of possible values to handle every case.
2. **They enable exhaustiveness checking.** If an execution system handles `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild`, it has handled all cases -- because the ontology guarantees there are no others.
3. **They convert open-world value domains into closed-world specifications.** Without enumeration, a property might have unknown or additional values. With enumeration, all values are known.
4. **They compose with other execution primitives.** Enumeration works with `hasValue` restrictions (**Exercise 25**) and cardinality restrictions (**Exercise 26**) to build richer execution logic. For example, an execution rule can fire on `hasSpiciness value Hot`, confident that `Hot` is a fixed, well-known value from a closed enumeration.

The table below contrasts the behavior of a property with and without an enumerated value domain:

Aspect	Without Enumeration	With Enumeration
Value domain	Open -- any value is possible in principle	Closed -- only the listed values are possible
Reasoner behavior	Cannot exhaustively check value conditions	Can exhaustively check value conditions
Semantic strength	Description of a class	Specification of a value domain
Execution readiness	Not executable for value-based triggers	Executable for value-based triggers

Key Insight:

> "Execution cannot handle unknown values. Enumeration is how the ontology guarantees that all values are known."

25.4.5 Engineering Perspective: Exercise 24 as a Case Study

From the perspective of Protégé, **Exercise 24** involves creating a class, creating three individuals, and adding a single `EquivalentTo` axiom. It appears to be a small modeling activity.

From the perspective of ontology engineering, however, something significant has occurred. The ontology now contains a **completely specified value domain** -- a closed-world set of possible values.

> What was previously an open class has become a fully enumerated one.

The engineering contribution of **Exercise 24** can be summarized as follows:

Engineering Perspective	Contribution from Exercise 24
SKDL Stage	Stage 7 -- Executable Knowledge
Primary Objective	Introduce the enumerated class as a value-domain specification
Modeling Activity	Define `Spiciness` as `{Hot, Medium, Mild}`
Engineering Outcome	Provide a finite, deterministic value domain for execution; the reasoner now treats `Spiciness` as a closed-world enumeration
Preparation for Later Sections	Establish the enumerated value foundation for the `hasValue` restrictions in **Exercise 25** and the cardinality-based logic in **Exercise 26**

Key Insight:

> "**Exercise 24** is the moment the ontology specifies a complete value domain. This is essential for exhaustive execution logic."

Tip

Following the Tutorial

Exercise 24 in the original `Pizza` Tutorial introduces the enumerated class `Spiciness` with the individuals `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild`, and defines `Spiciness` as `EquivalentTo {Hot, Medium, Mild}`. The tutorial then demonstrates the reasoner recognizing all three individuals as instances of the class.

In this book, we have followed the tutorial exactly -- same class, same individuals, same axiom. The only difference is presentational: we have added the observation that this constitutes a *closed-world specification of a value domain*, which is what makes enumeration as execution primitive for **Stage 7**. The tutorial introduces the construct; the book frames it in terms of executability.

25.5 Exercise 25 -- `hasValue` Restrictions and Specific-Value Binding

Having established the enumerated value domain in **Exercise 24**, we now turn to **Exercise 25**, which introduces the `hasValue` **restriction** -- the construct that binds a property to a specific individual.

This exercise completes the value-binding layer of Stage 7. In **Exercise 24**, we closed the world for a *value domain* (`Spiciness = {Hot, Medium, Mild}`). In **Exercise 25**, we close the world for a *specific value* -- binding a property to one particular individual from that domain.

25.5.1 The Engineering Objective

Exercise 25 introduces the `hasValue` **restriction**, which specifies that a property must have exactly one specific value.

A `hasValue` restriction for a spicy pizza, for example, would be:

```
Class: SpicyPizza
  EquivalentTo: Pizza and (hasTopping some (hasSpiciness value Hot))
```

This means:

> "A pizza is a `SpicyPizza` if and only if (`iff`) it has at least one topping whose spiciness is `Hot`."

The engineering objective of **Exercise 25** is to demonstrate how `hasValue` restrictions enable **value-based execution logic** -- the ability to fire a trigger on a specific value rather than a general class of values.

Why does execution need `hasValue`?

Consider an execution rule that fires when a pizza's spiciness is `Hot`. For the rule to be reliable, the system must be able to detect the *specific value* `Hot` -- not just any value from the `Spiciness` class. The `hasValue` restriction is the OWL construct that expresses this specific-value condition.

Where **Exercise 24** gave us the *closed value domain*, **Exercise 25** gives us the *specific value binding*.

Together, they form the value layer of executability.

Key Insight:

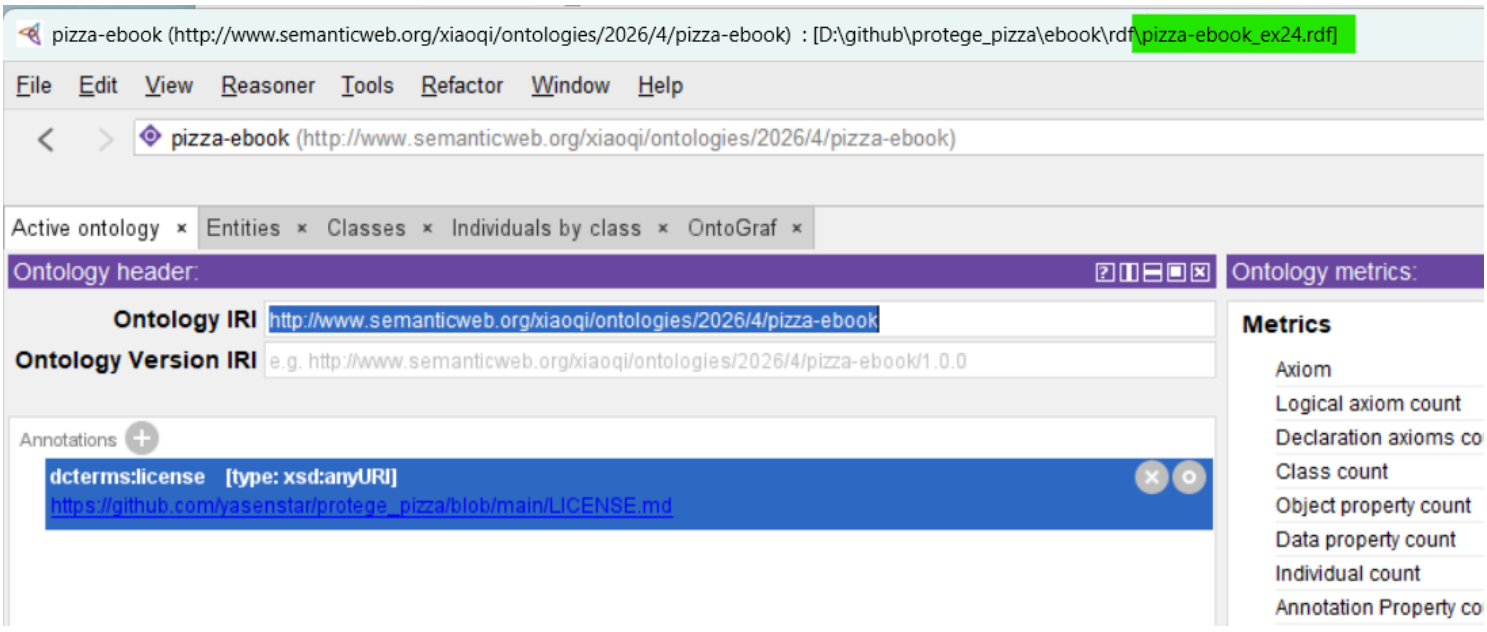
> "The `hasValue` restriction is the semantic equivalent of a conditional statement. It says: if the value is X, then the condition is true."

25.5.2 Implementation: Creating the `hasValue` Restriction

Let's walk through the implementation step by step. The workflow introduces a new property, then uses it to bind a specific value in two places: on a topping class, and in a defined pizza class.

Step 1: Open the `Pizza` ontology

Open `pizza-ebook_ex24.rdf` in Protégé -- the file from the previous exercise, which now contains the enumerated class `Spiciness` with its three instances `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild`. It also contains closure axioms from **Exercise 23**.

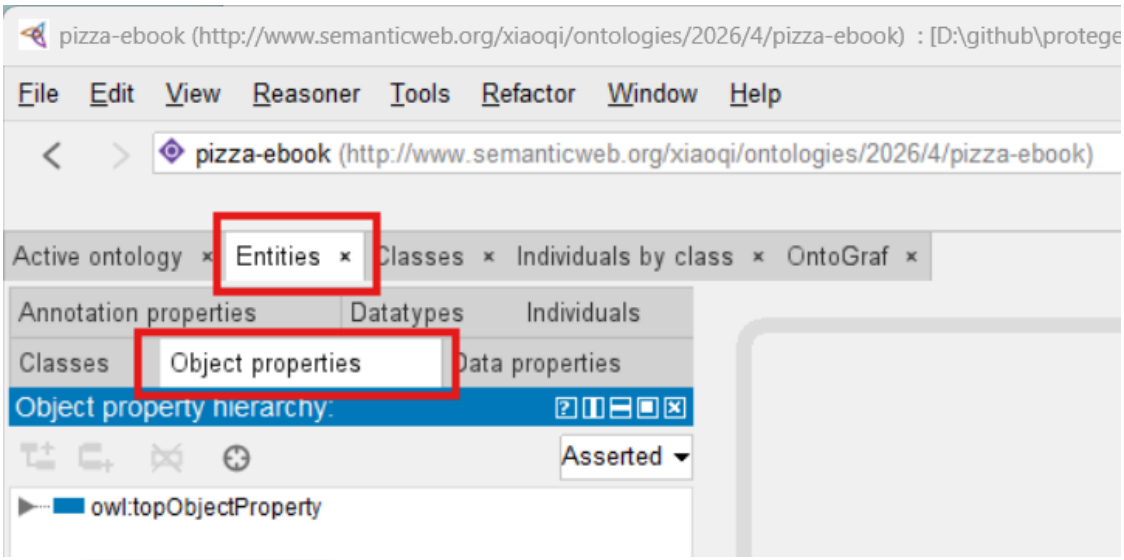


> **Note**
>
> The finished state of **Exercise 25** will be saved as `pizza-ebook_ex25.rdf`.
> Two changes in the RDF for your attention:
>
> 1. Ontology IRI remove the exercise number context, keep as `http://www.semanticweb.org/xiaoqi/ontologies/2026/4/pizza-ebook` so that you don't need to change PREFIX when you create SPARQL queries.

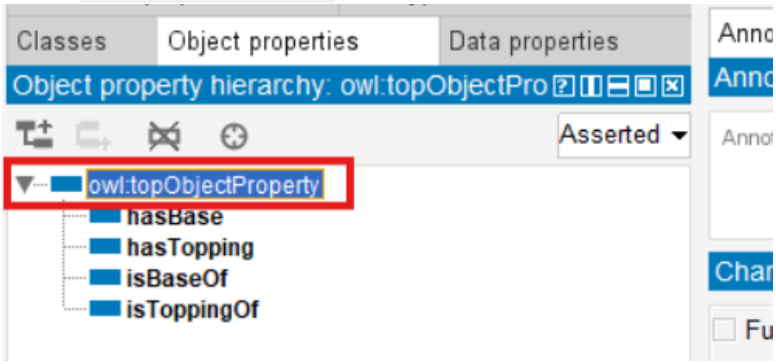
2. License link is updated as https://github.com/yasenstar/protege_pizza/blob/main/LICENSE.md

Step 2: Create the `hasSpiciness` object property

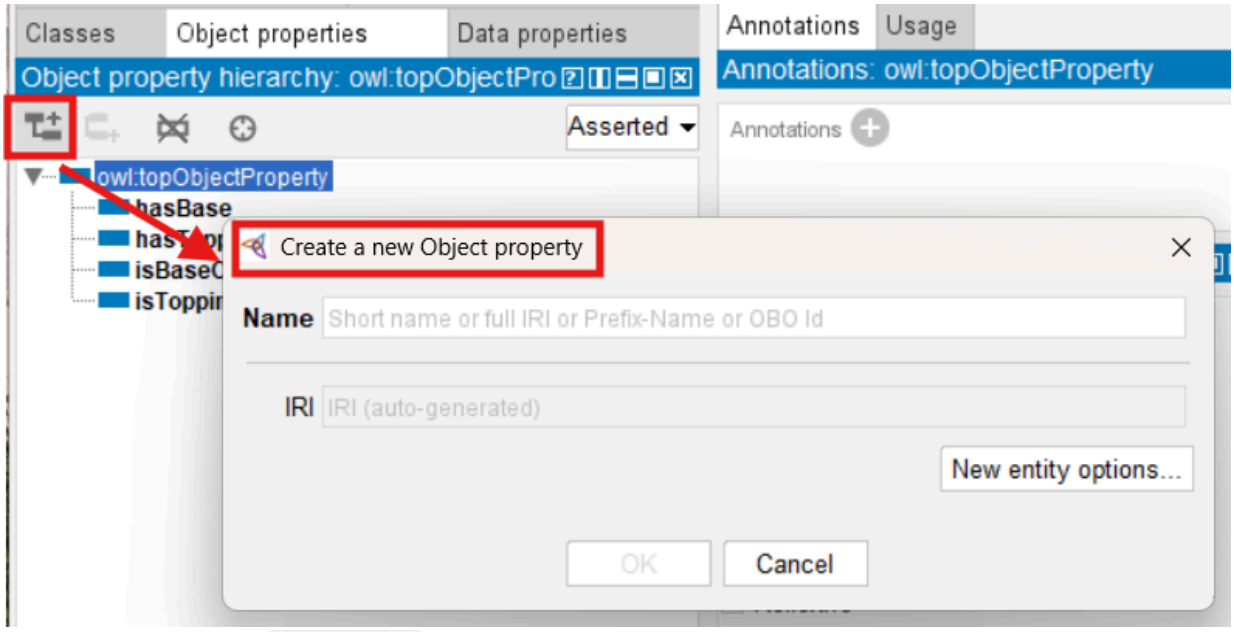
1. Navigate to the **Object properties** tab. (Under **Entities** tab)



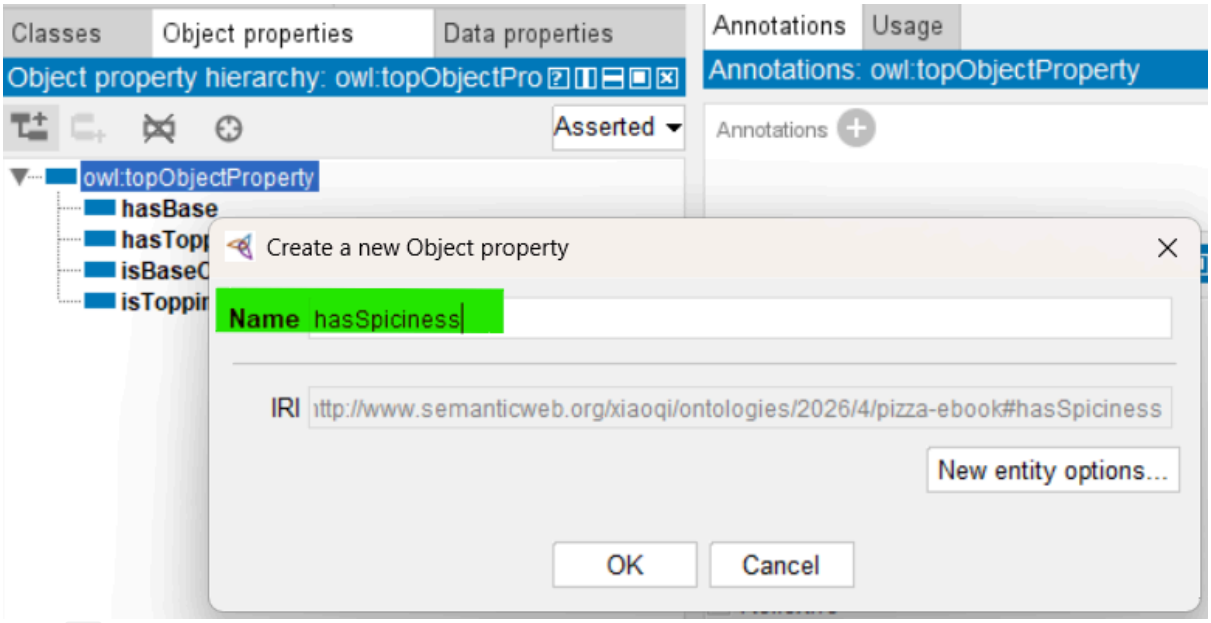
2. Select `owl:topObjectProperty` in the property hierarchy



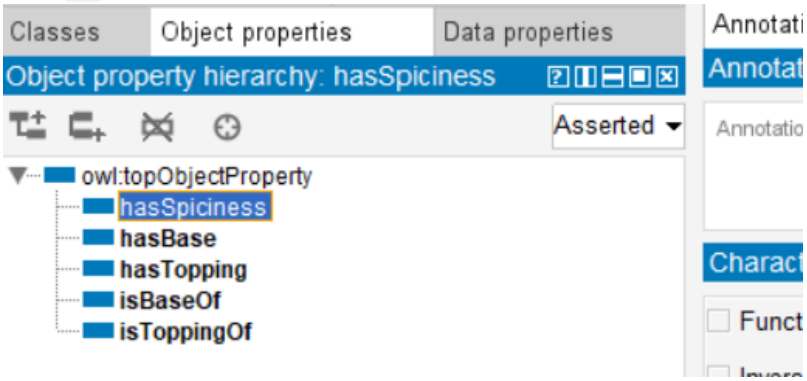
3. Click the **Add sub property** icon



4. Name the new property `hasSpiciness`

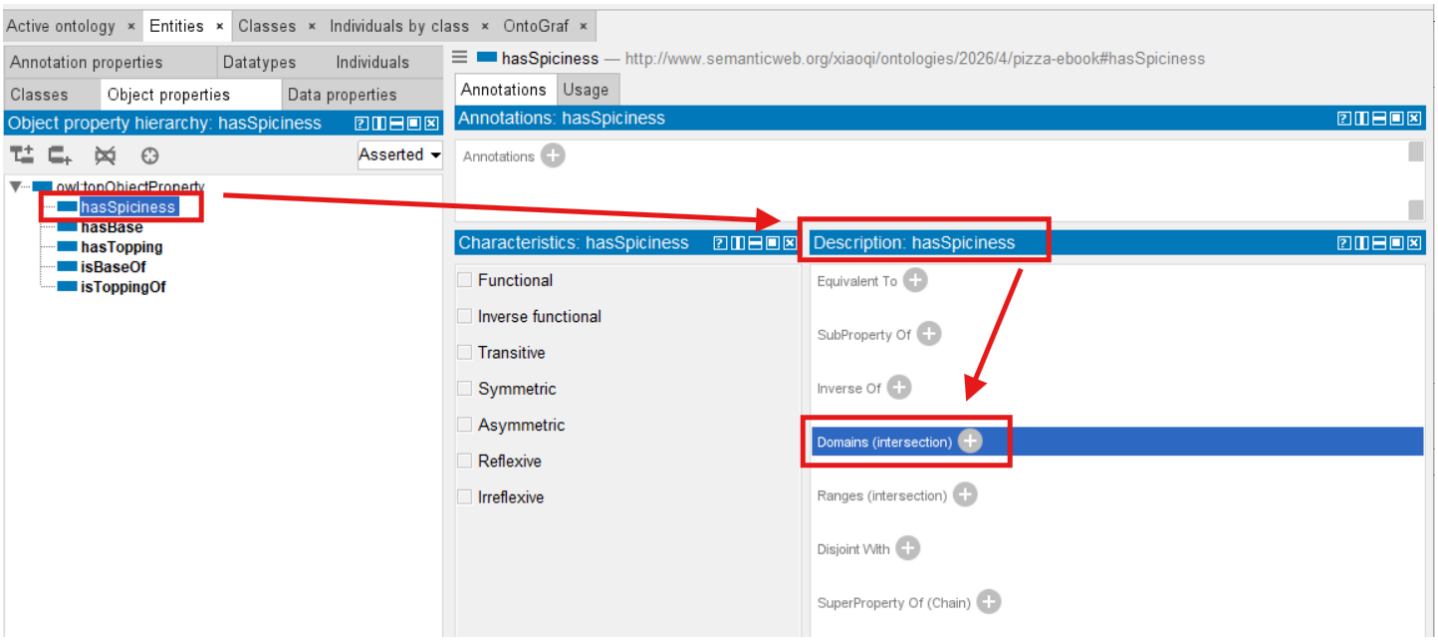


5. Click `OK`.

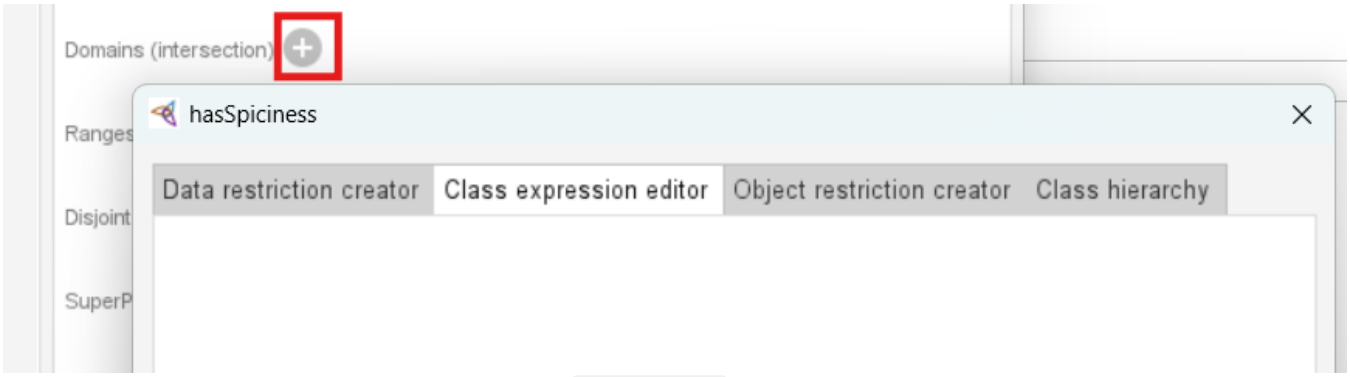


Step 3: Define the domain and range of `hasSpiciness`

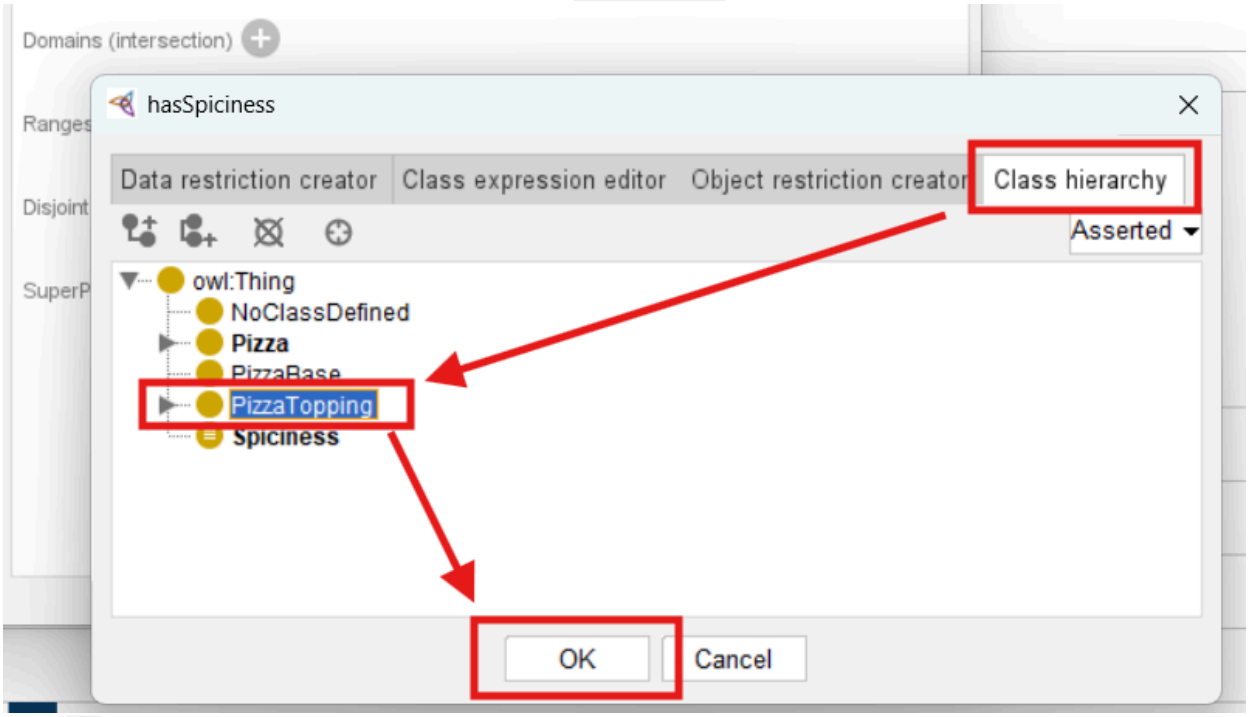
1. Select `hasSpiciness` in the property hierarchy
2. In the Description view, locate the **Domains (intersection)** section



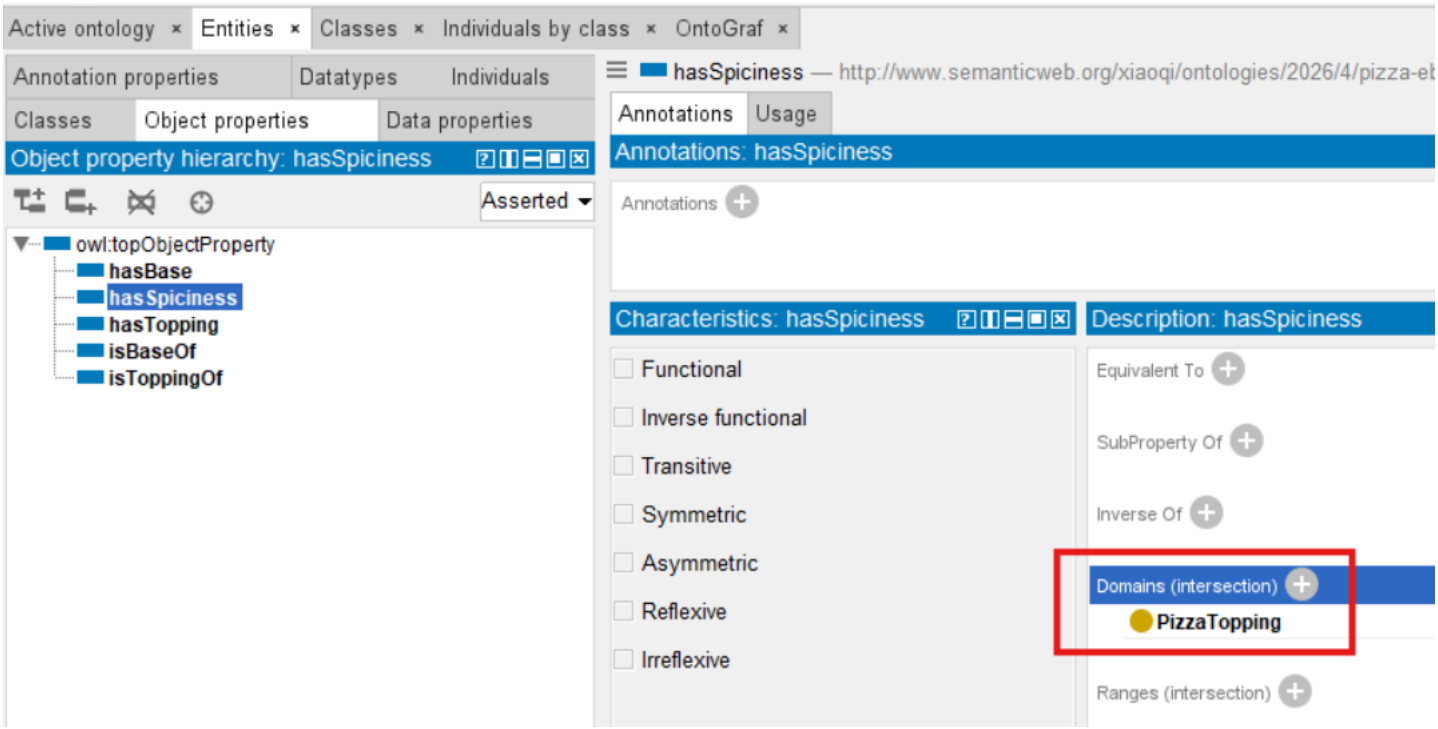
3. Click the Add icon (+), it may keep showing your previous tab, like this `Class expression editor`



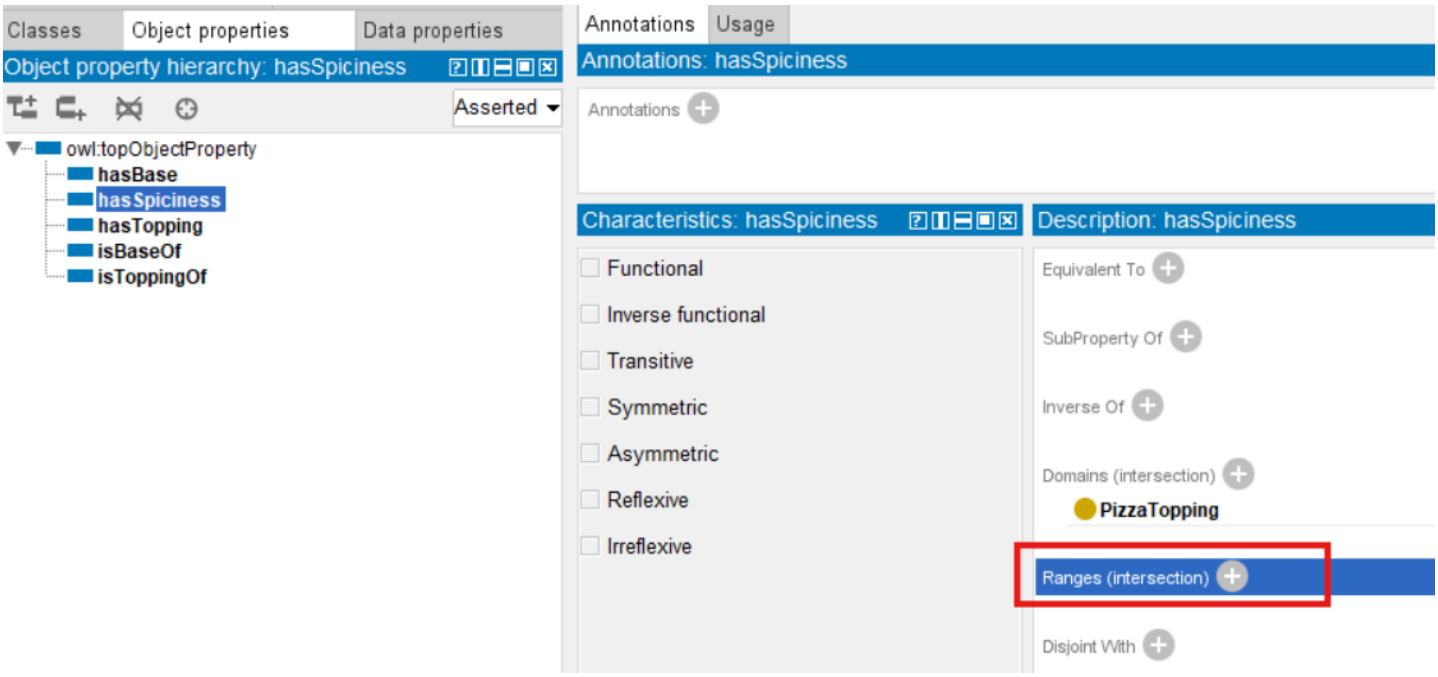
4. In the dialog, use the **Class hierarchy** tab to select `PizzaTopping`



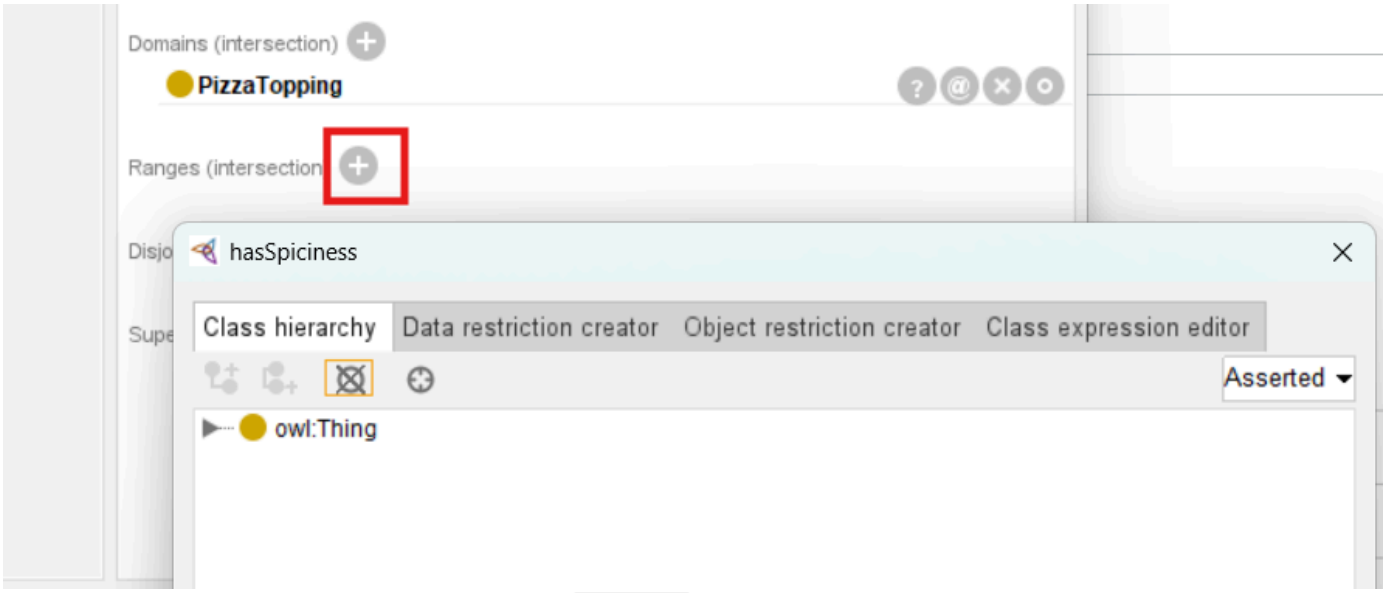
5. Click `OK`



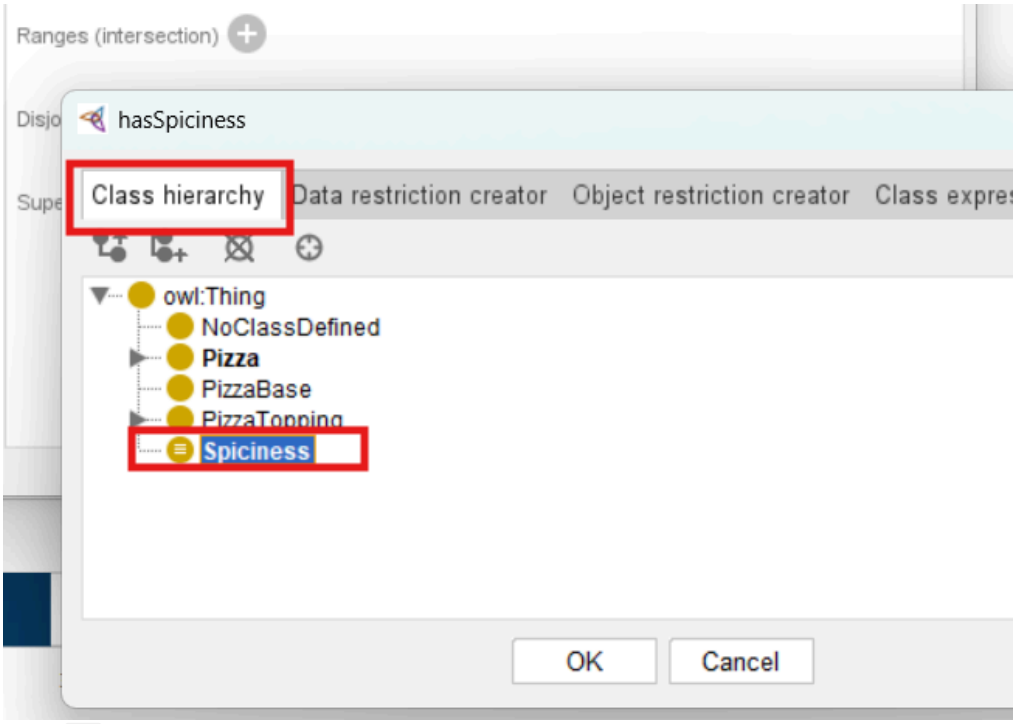
6. In the Description view, locate the **Range (intersection)** section



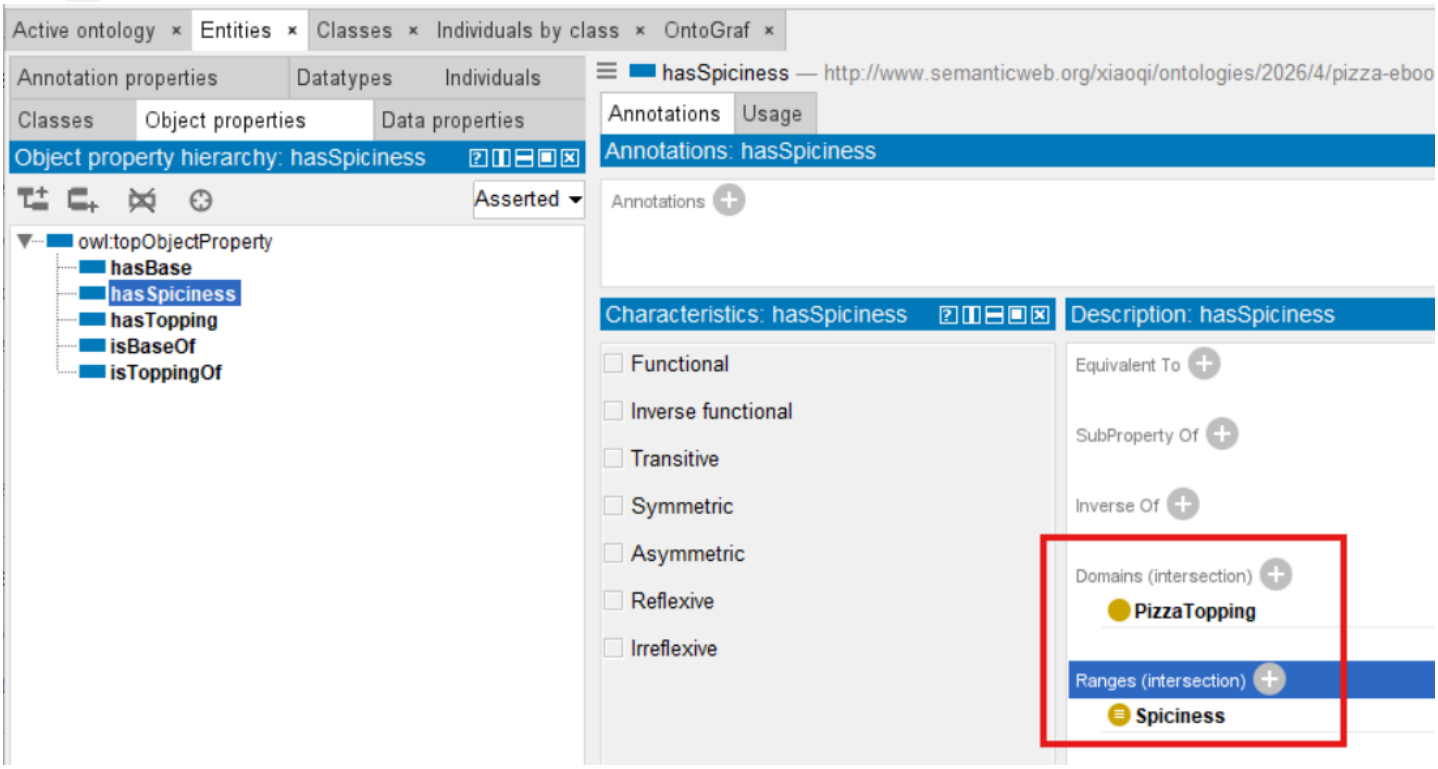
7. Click the Add icon (+)



8. In the dialog, use the **Class hierarchy** tab to select `Spiciness`



9. Click `OK`



After this step, `hasSpiciness` has the following description:

```
Object Property: hasSpiciness
   Domain: PizzaTopping
   Range: Spiciness
```

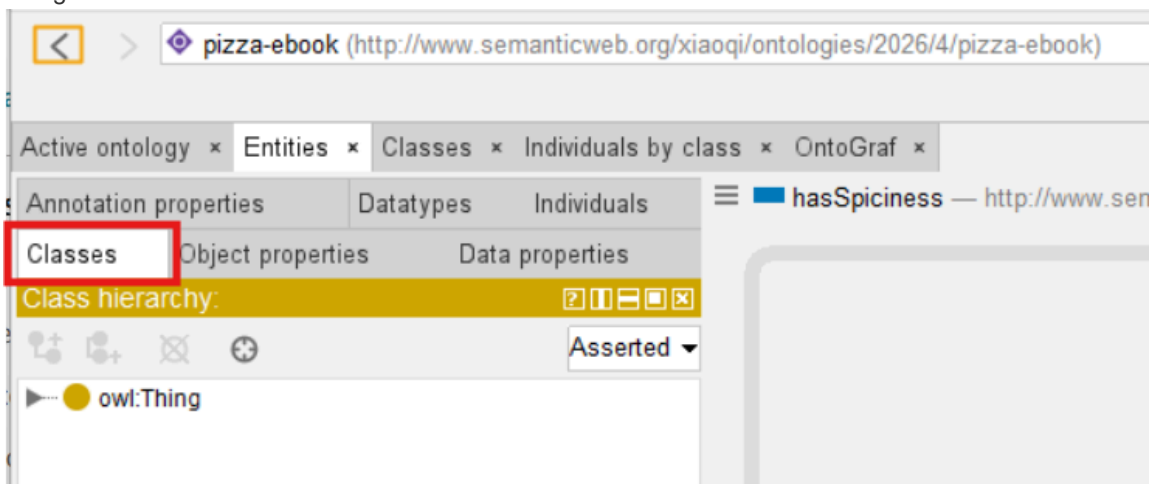
Step 4: Synchronize the reasoner

Select `Reasoner > Synchronize reasoner` (Ctrl+R).

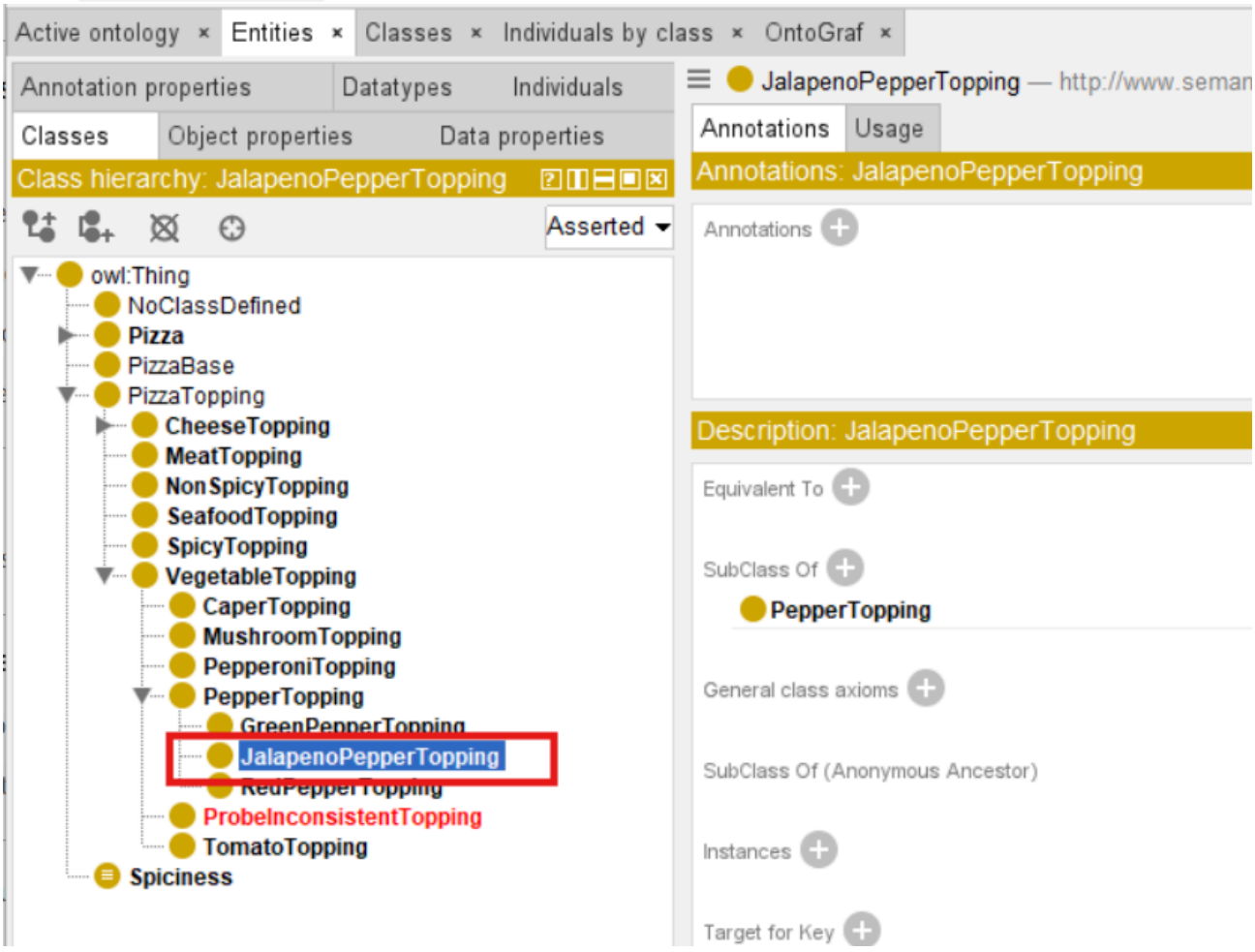
The reasoner now knows about the new property and its domain/range constraints. This is important before we use the property in restrictions -- the reasoner will validate that the restrictions we add are consistent with the property's signature.

Step 5: Add the `hasValue` restriction to `JalapenoPepperTopping`

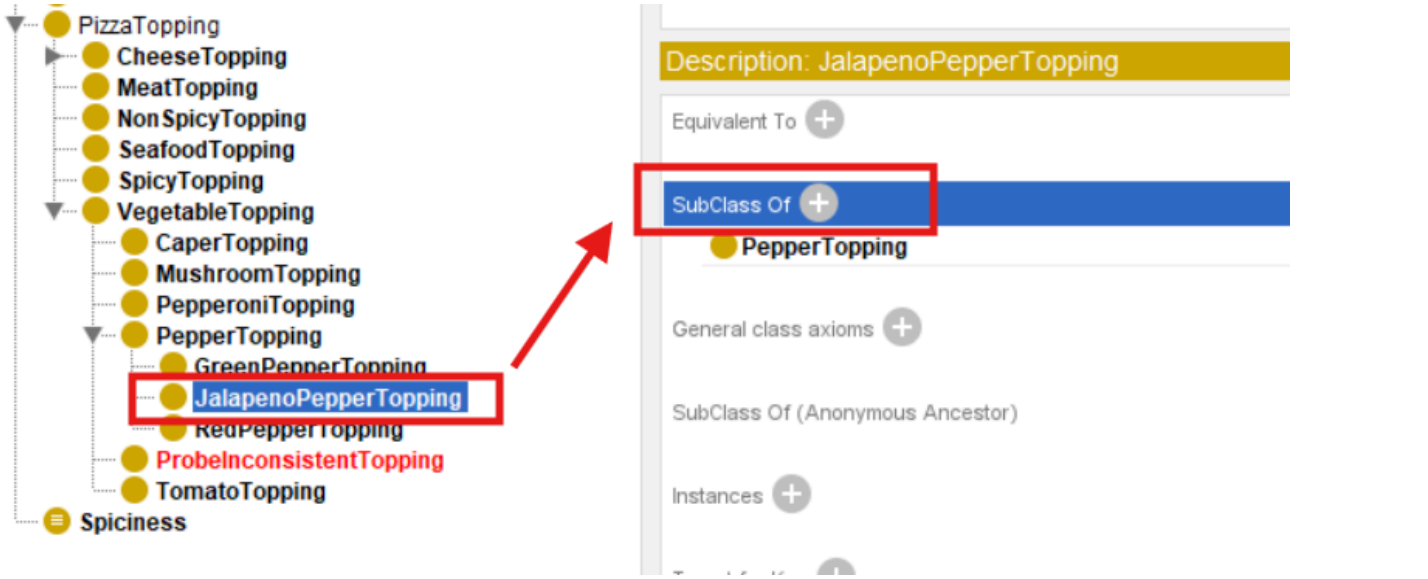
1. Navigate to the **Classes** tab



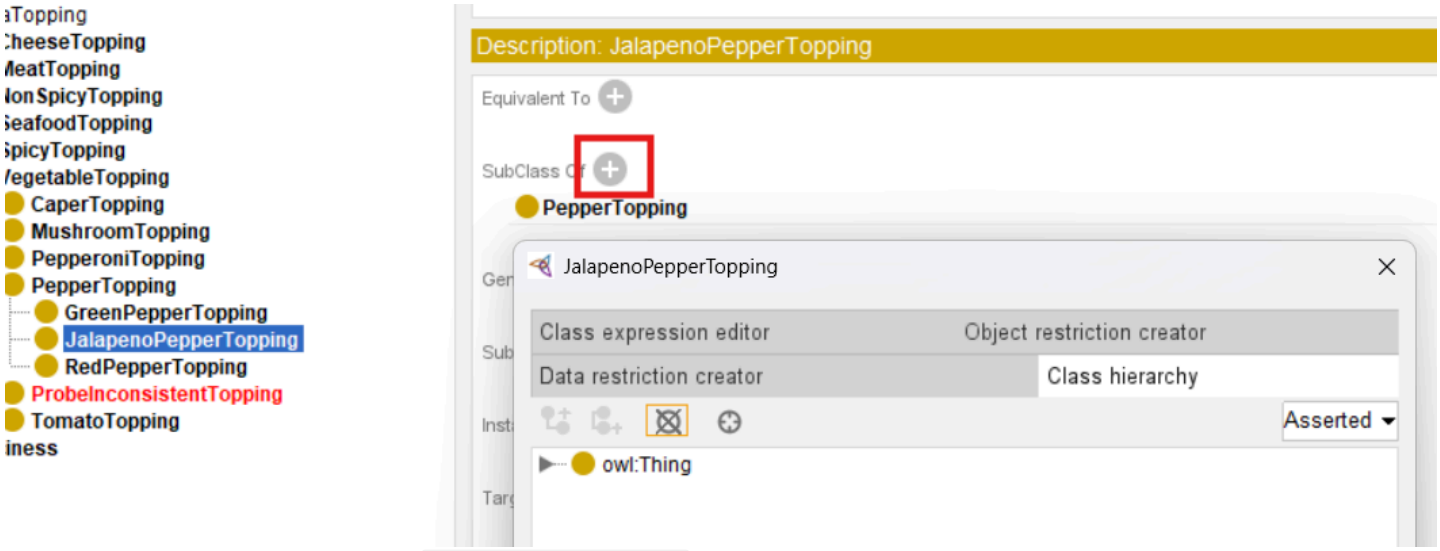
2. Select `JalapenoPepperTopping` in the class hierarchy



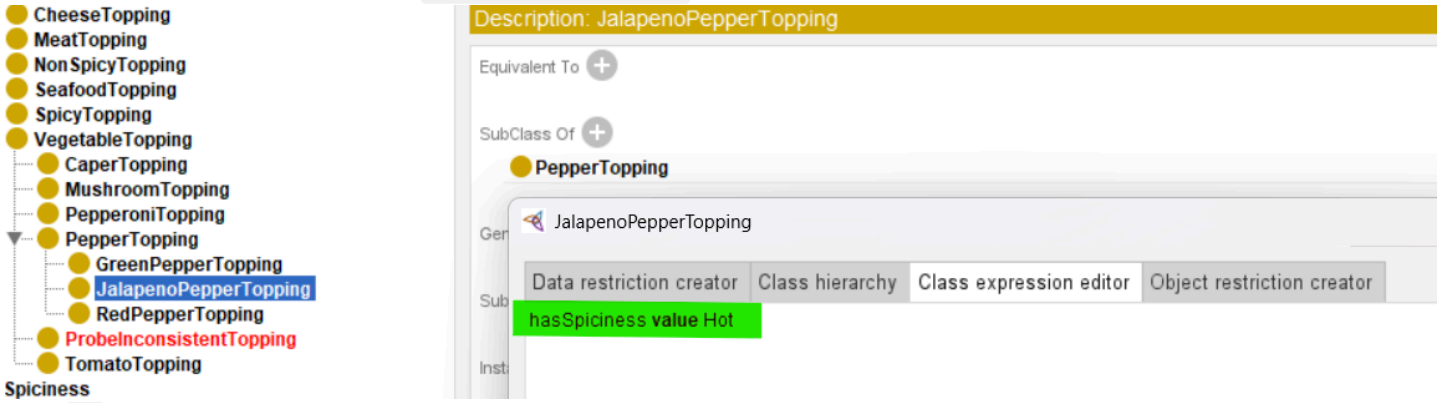
3. In the **Description** view, locate the **SubClass Of** section



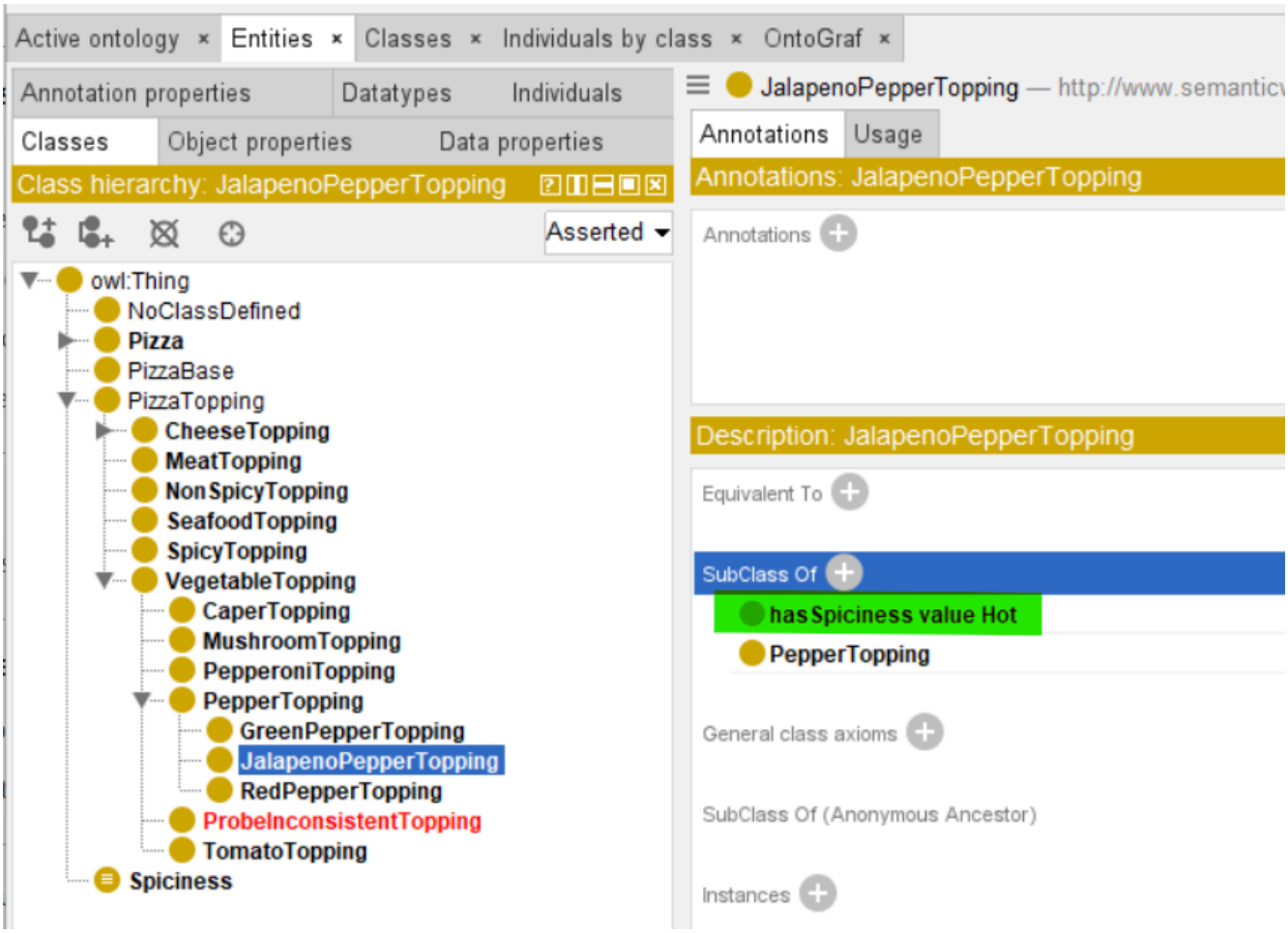
4. Click the Add icon (+)



5. In the Class Expression Editor, enter: `hasSpiciness value Hot`



6. Click `OK`



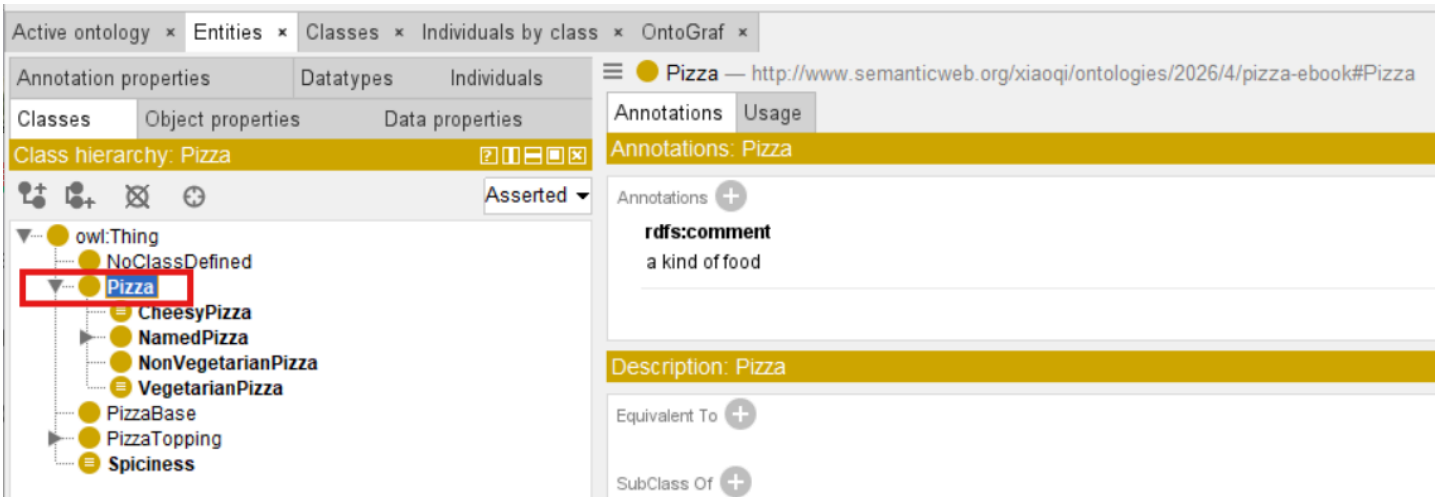
After this step, `JalapenoPepperTopping` has:

```
Class: JalapenoPepperTopping
   SubClassOf: PepperTopping
   SubClassOf: hasSpiciness value Hot
```

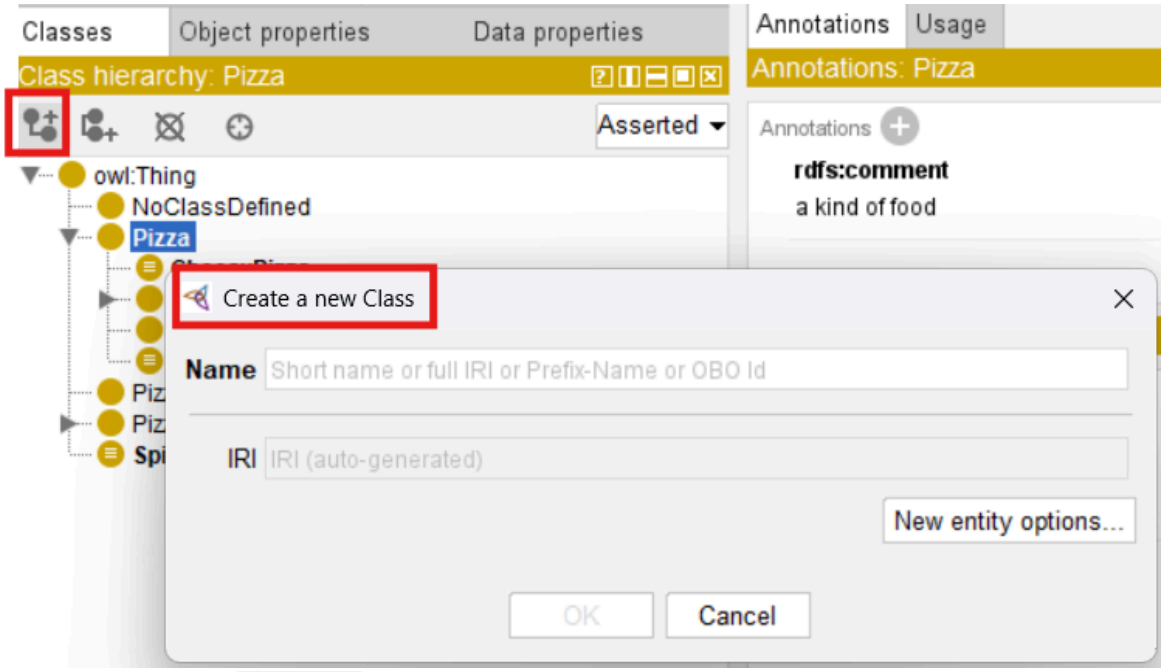
> **Note**
>
> This is a different kind of restriction from the ones we have ever used before. In `some` and `only` restrictions, the filler was a *class* -- `hasTopping some CheeseTopping` says "at least one cheese topping," but does not specify *which* cheese topping. In a `value` restriction, the filler is a *specific individual* -- `hasSpiciness value Hot` says the spiciness must be exactly the individual `Hot`. This is why the keyword is `value` rather than `some` or `only`.

Step 6: Create the `SpicyPizza` class

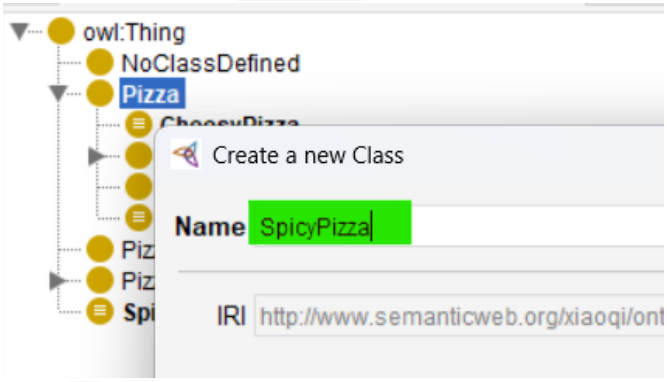
1. Make sure `Pizza` is selected in the class hierarchy



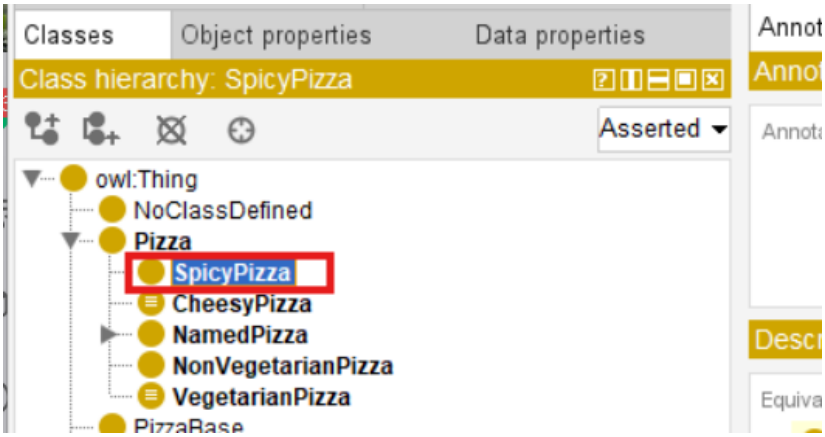
2. Click the **Add subclass** icon.



3. Name the new class `SpicyPizza`

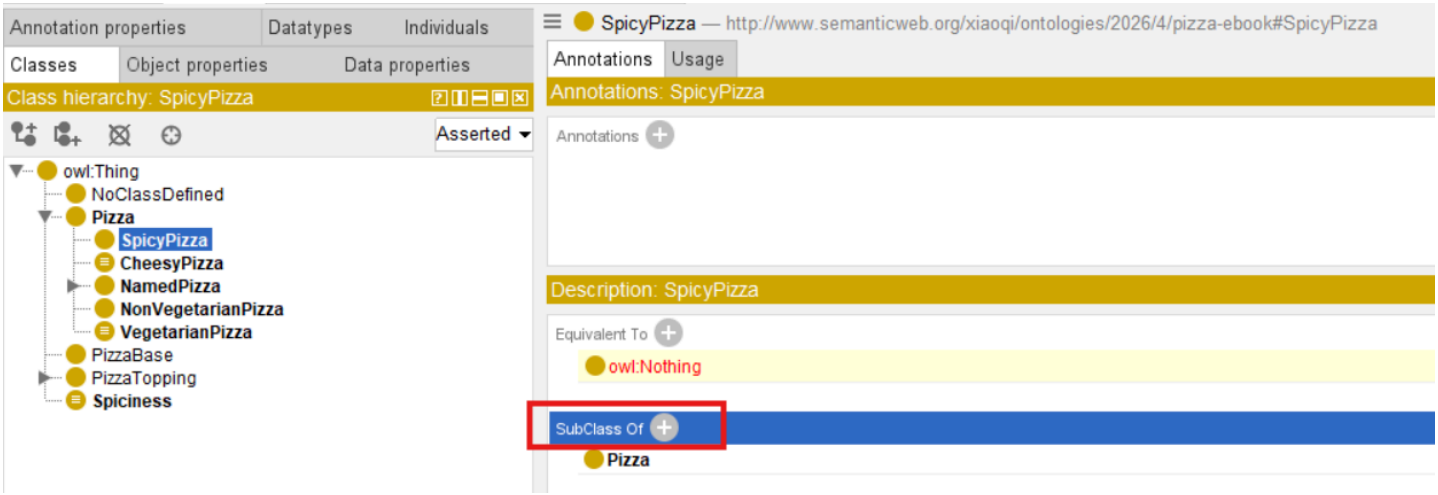


4. Click `OK`

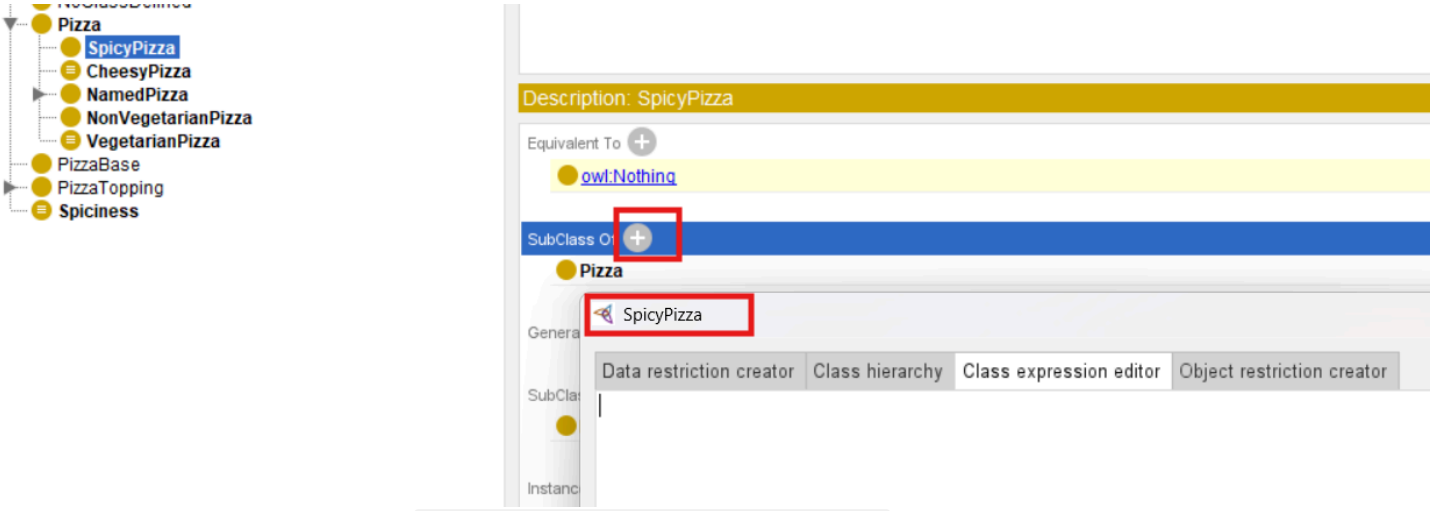


Step 7: Add the nested `hasValue` restriction to `SpicyPizza`

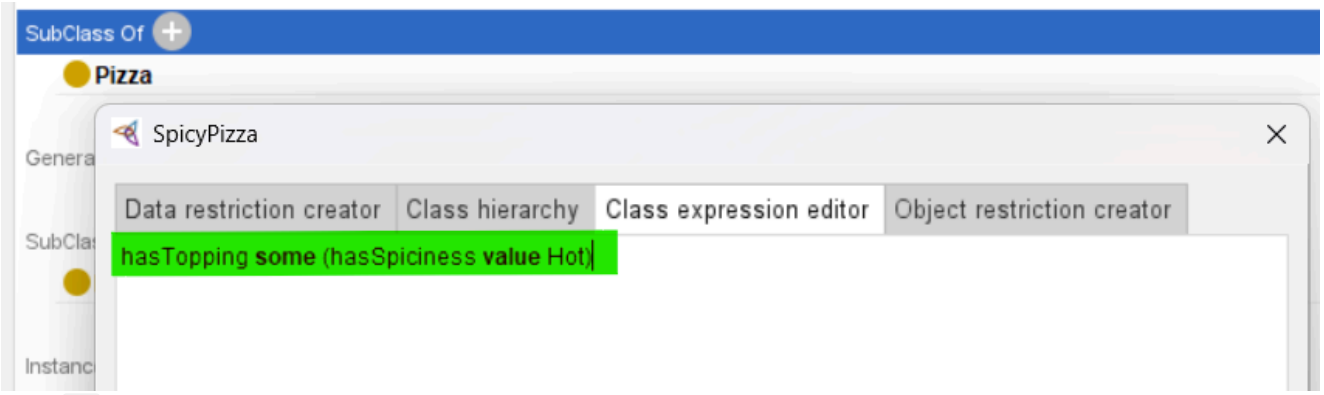
1. Select `SpicyPizza`
2. In the **Description** view, locate the **SubClass Of** section



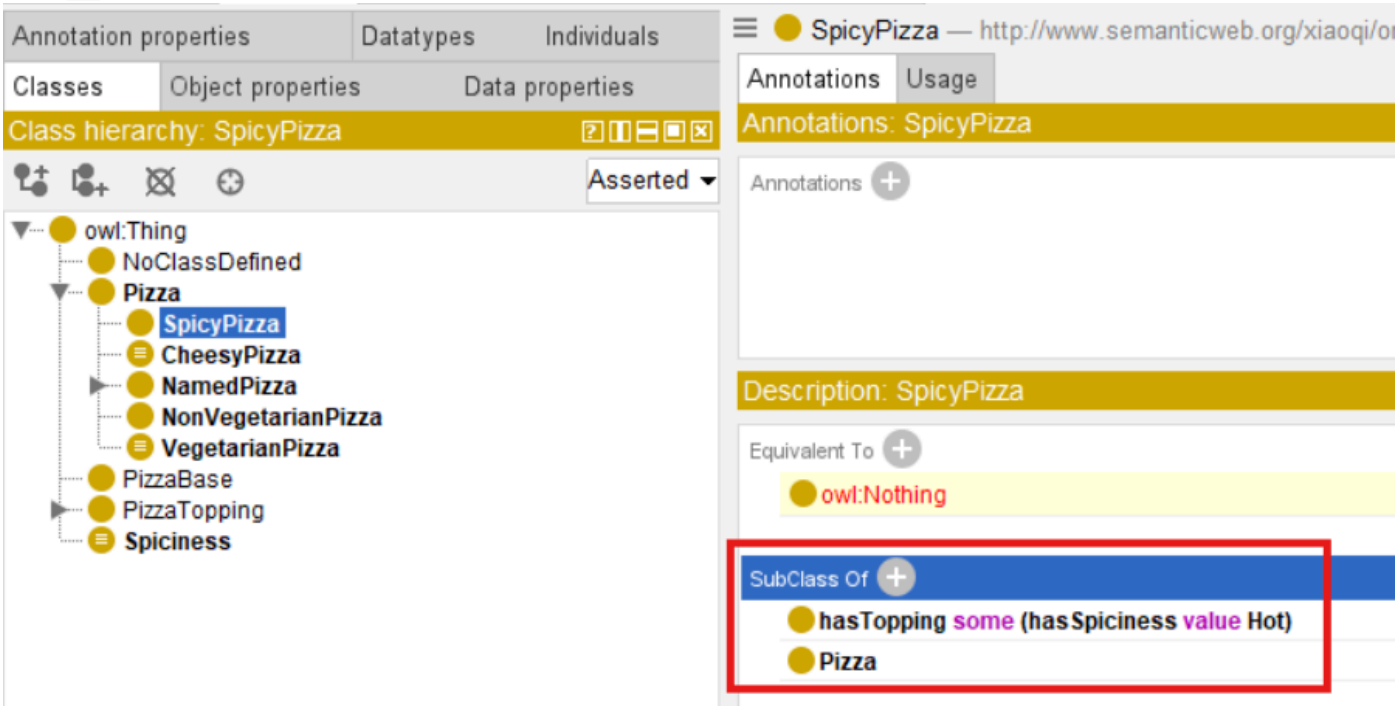
3. Click the Add icon (+)



4. In the Class Expression Editor, enter: `hasTopping some (hasSpiciness value Hot)`



5. Click `OK`



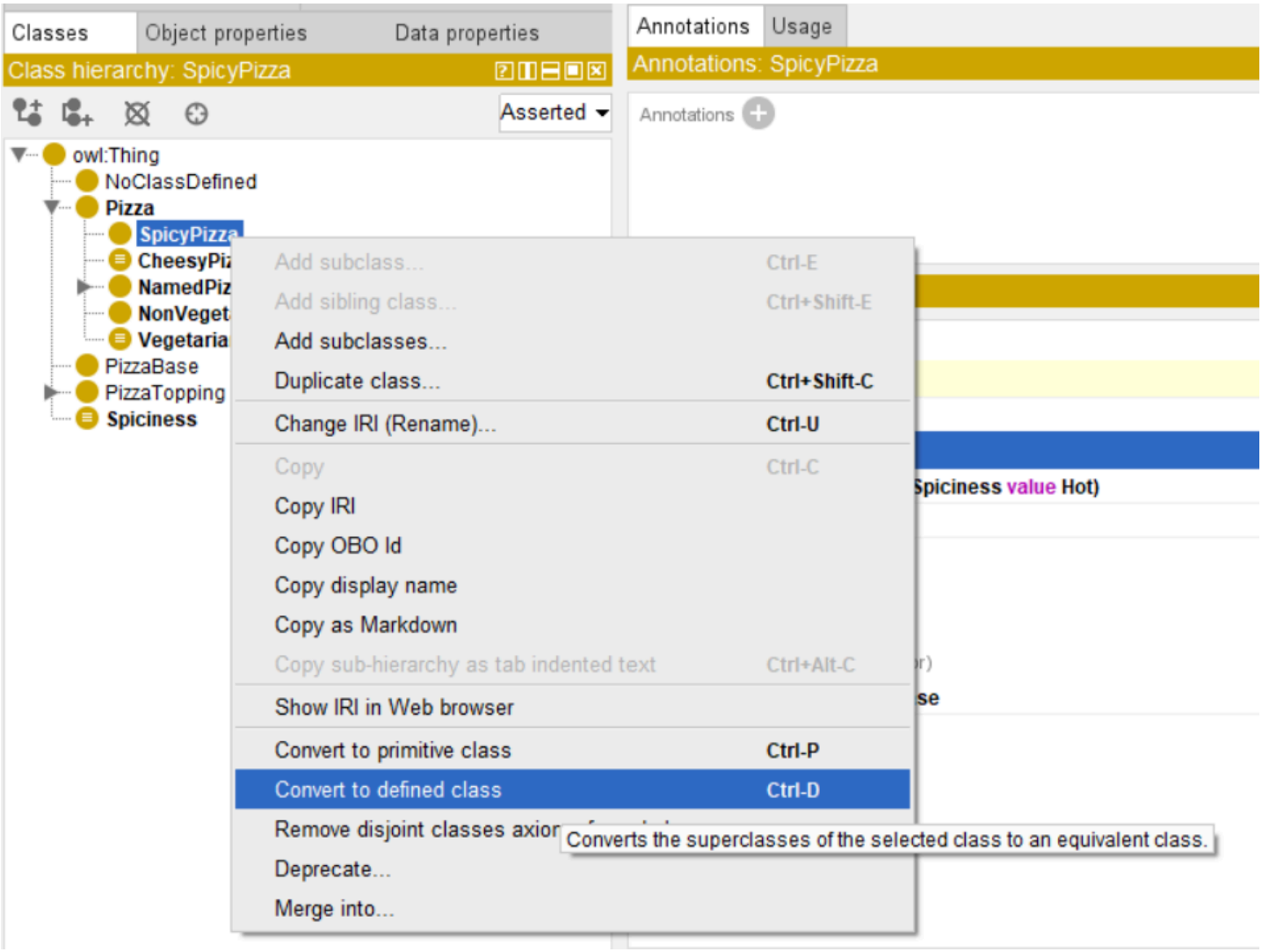
After this step, `SpicyPizza` has:

```
Class: SpicyPizza
   SubClassOf: Pizza
   SubClassOf: hasTopping some (hasSpiciness value Hot)
```

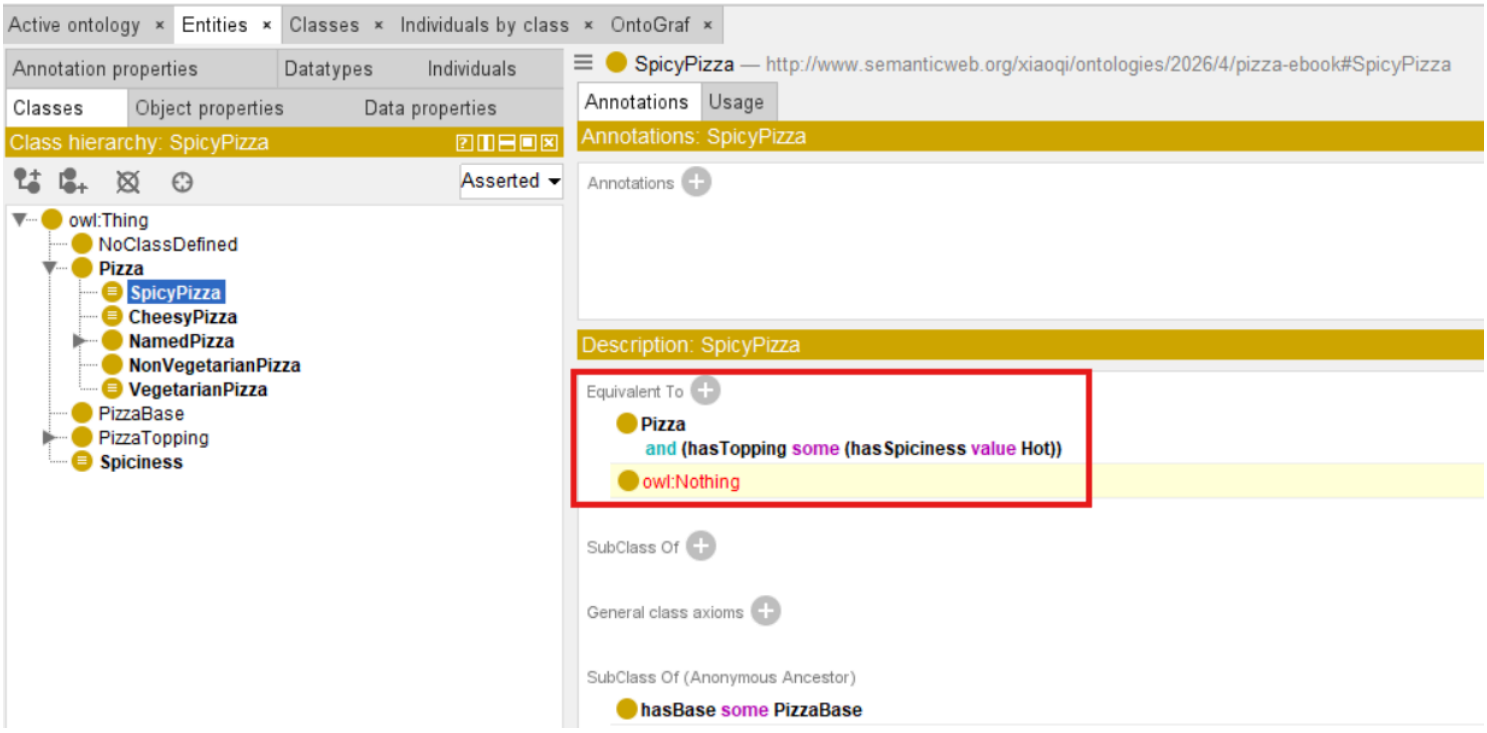
This says: "A `SpicyPizza` must have at least one topping whose `hasSpiciness` property value is `Hot`." Note the *nesting*: `hasTopping some (...)` is an existential restriction whose filler is itself a `hasValue` restriction. This composition is what makes the pattern powerful -- a restriction inside a restriction.

Step 8: Convert `SpicyPizza` to a defined class

1. Make sure `SpicyPizza` is still selected
2. Select `Edit > Convert to defined class` (or from right-click menu)



Observe what happens in the Description view. The `SubClassOf` axiom for the existential restriction is moved to `EquivalentTo`:



```
Class: SpicyPizza
   EquivalentTo: Pizza and (hasTopping some (hasSpiciness value Hot))
   SubClassOf: Pizza
```

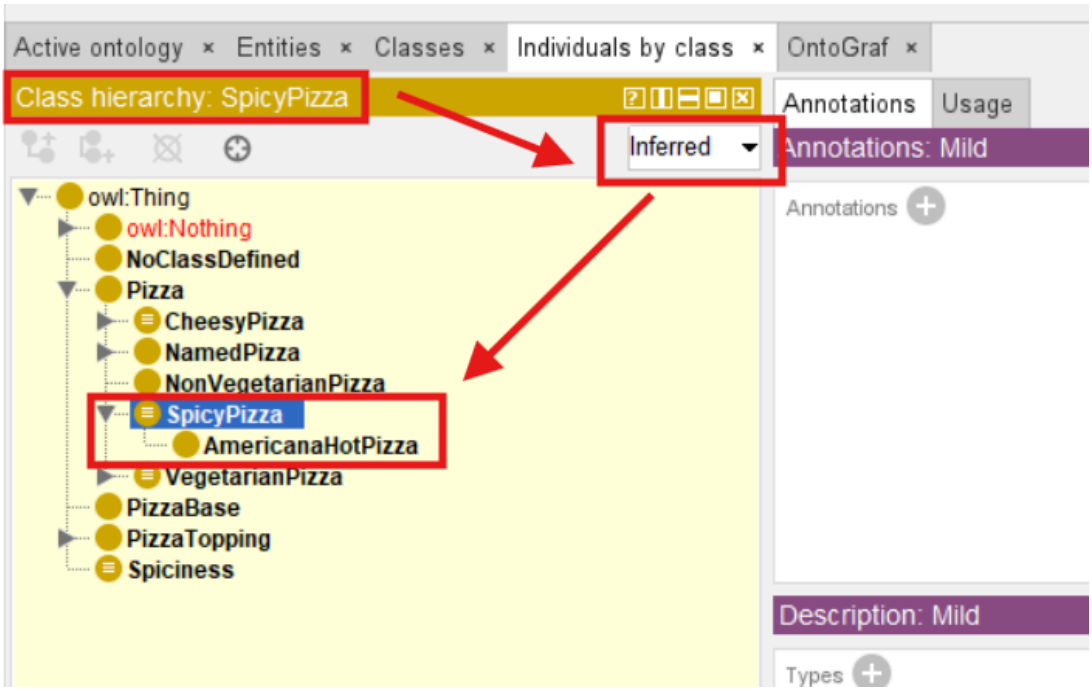
> **Note**
>
> The `SpicyPizza` class is now shown with three horizontal stripes in the class icon -- the visual indicator that it is a defined class.

Step 9: Synchronize the reasoner

Select `Reasoner > Synchronize reasoner` (Ctrl+R)

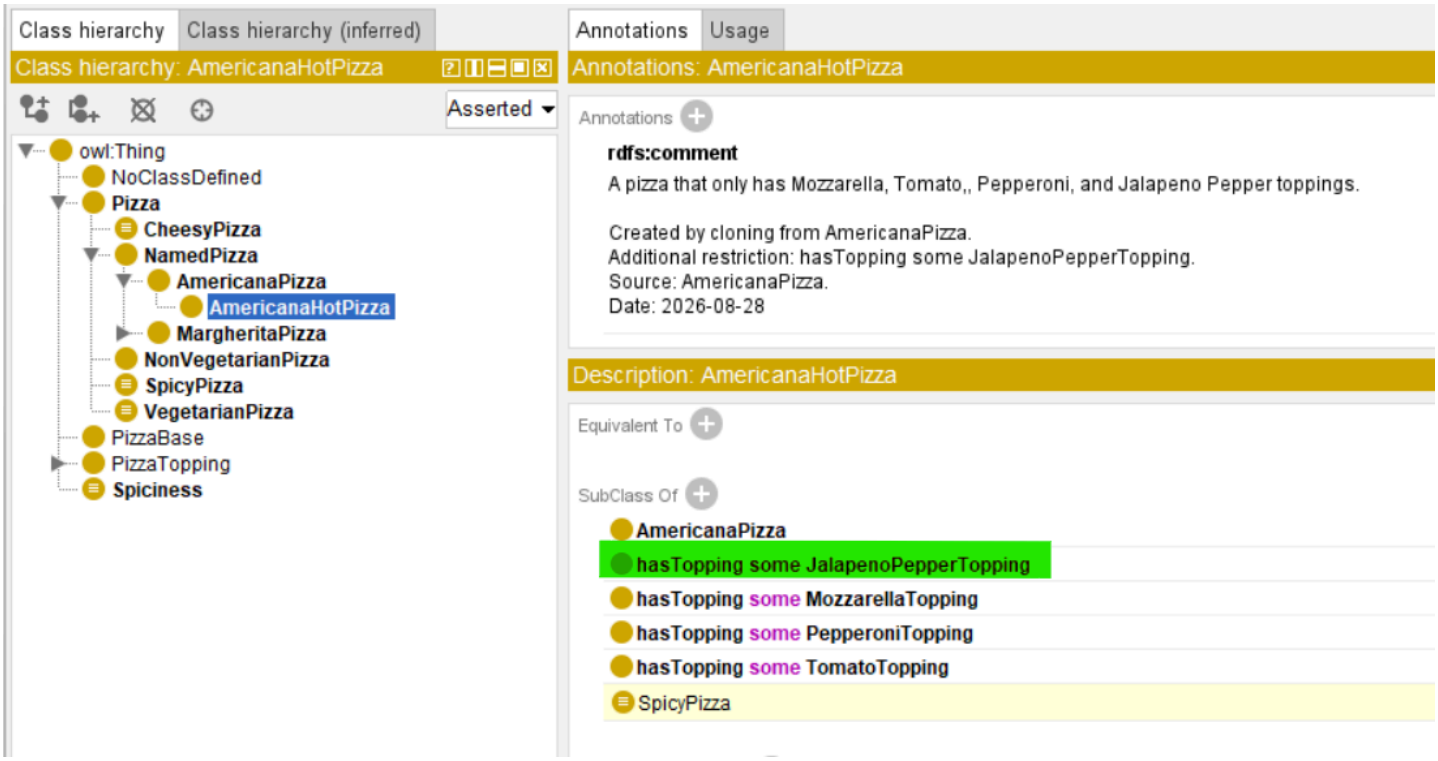
Step 10: Observe the result

Look at the **Class hierarchy (inferred)** tab:

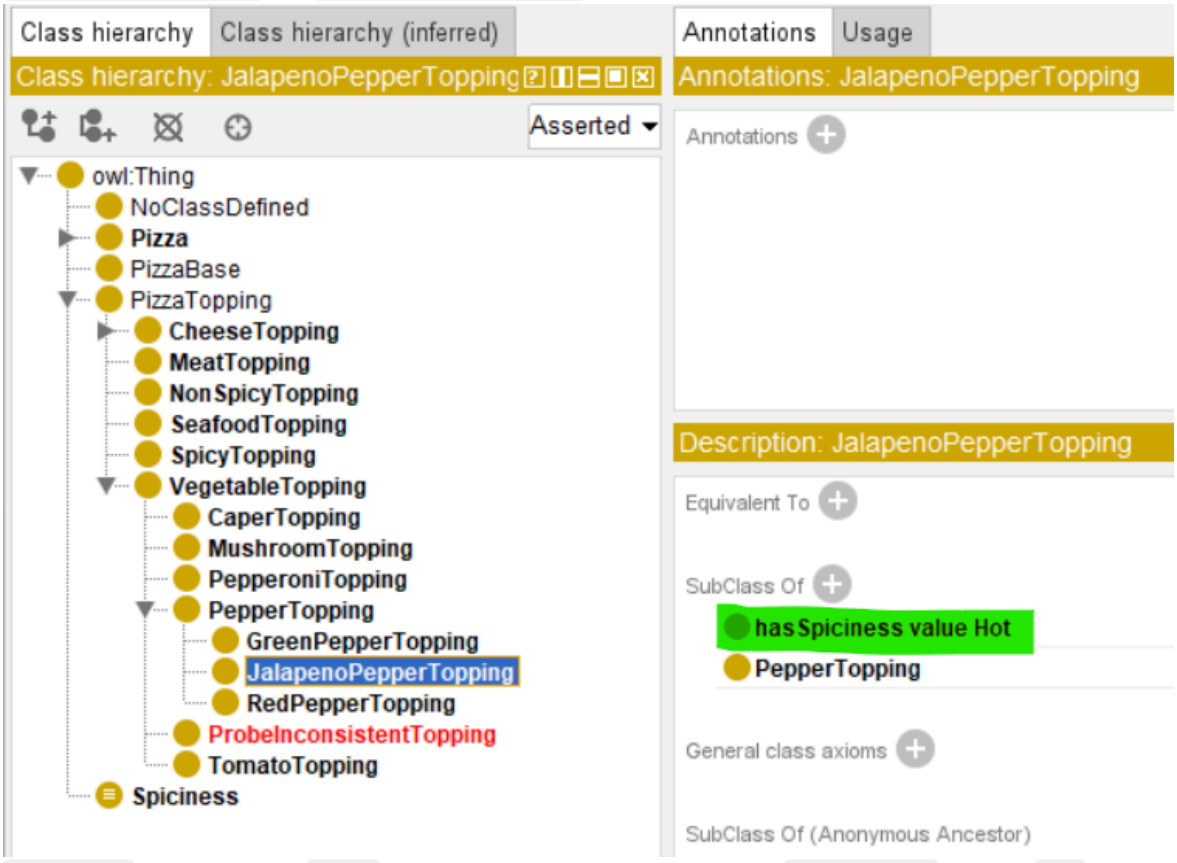


The reasoner now classifies `AmericanaHotPizza` as a **subclass of** `SpicyPizza`. This is because:

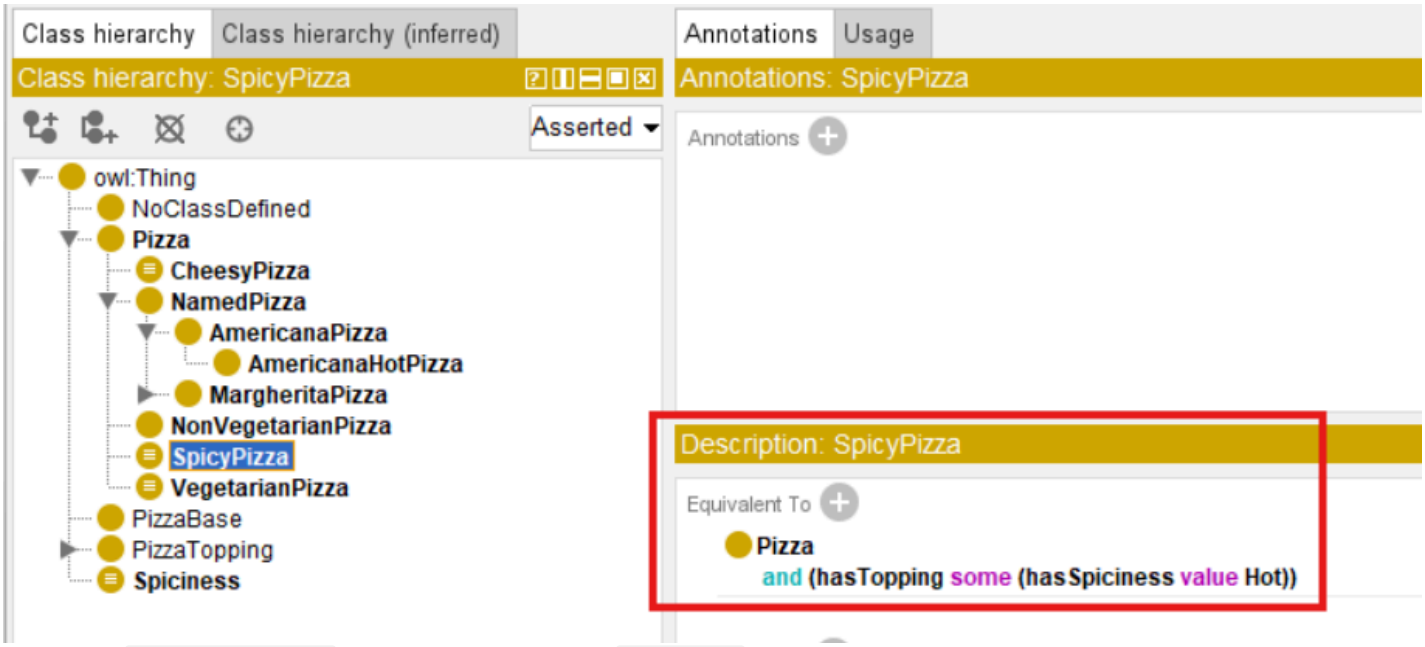
1. `AmericanaHotPizza` has a topping `JalapenoPepperTopping` (inherited from `AmericanaPizza`)



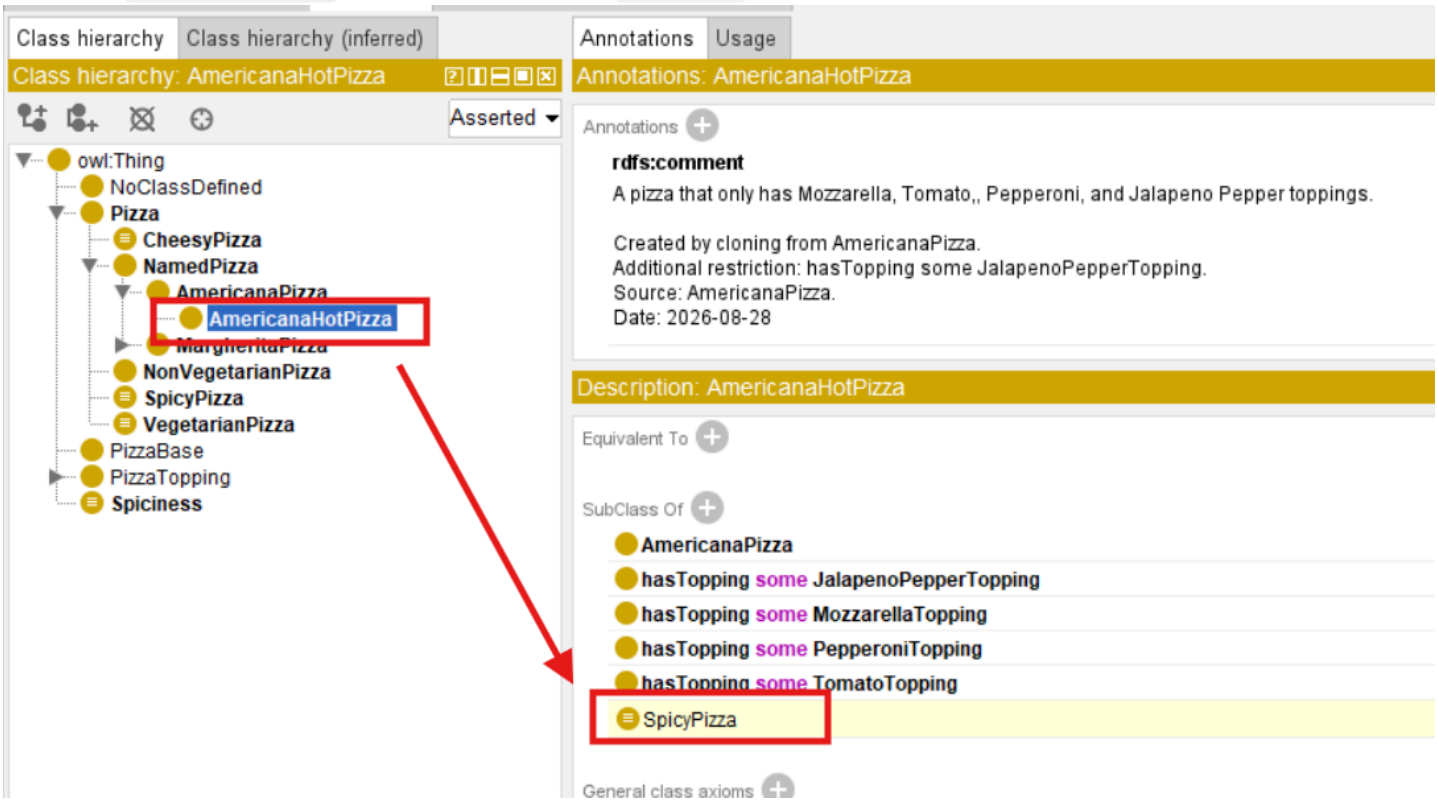
2. `JalapenoPepperTopping` has `hasSpiciness value Hot`.



3. `SpicyPizza` is defined as a `Pizza` that has at least one topping whose `hasSpiciness` value is `Hot`



4. Therefore, `AmericanaHotPizza` satisfies the definition of `SpicyPizza`



The reasoner has done something the human ontology engineer did not explicitly state. We never asserted that `AmericanaHotPizza` is a `SpicyPizza`. We asserted that it has `JalapenoPepperTopping`, and that `JalapenoPepperTopping` has spiciness `Hot`. The reasoner combined these facts with the definition of `SpicyPizza` and derived the classification automatically.

Key Insight:

> "The reasoner did not change. The definition of `SpicyPizza` did not change. Only the chain of facts changed -- from '`JalapenoPepperTopping` is a topping of `AmericanaHotPizza`' and '`JalapenoPepperTopping` has spiciness `Hot`' to '`AmericanaHotPizza` is a `SpicyPizza`'. Once the chain is complete, the reasoner can make the inference."

25.5.3 The Result: Value-Based Execution Logic

The `hasValue` restriction has enabled **value-based execution logic**.

For execution, this is essential. Many execution rules depend on **specific values**, not general classes of values.

For example:

- "If the temperature reading is `Critical`, then trigger an alert."
- "If the order status is `Pending`, then send a reminder."
- "If the customer tier is `Gold`, then apply a discount."

Each of these rules fires on a *specific value* from a closed value domain. The `hasValue` restriction is the OWL construct that expresses this condition.

Contrast this with the alternative. In **Exercise 22**, we used to universal restriction (`hasTopping only ...`) to describe *what is allowed*. That restriction expressed a boundary, not a specific trigger. In **Exercise 23**, we used closure axioms to *close the world* for those boundaries. Now, in **Exercise 25**, we use `hasValue` to *bind a trigger* to a specific value.

The four constructs work together:

Construct	Role	Exercise
Universal restriction (`only`)	Defines what is allowed	Ex 22
Closure axiom	Closes the world for a class or individual	Ex 23
Enumerated class	Defines a closed value domain	Ex 24
`hasValue` restriction	**Binds a property to a specific value**	**Ex 25**

Each construct builds on the previous one. The universal restriction establishes a boundary. The closure axiom makes the boundary usable for classification. The enumerated class narrows the value domain to a finite set. And the `hasValue` restriction binds a trigger to one specific value within that domain.

Key Insight:

> " `hasValue` is the most direct connection between ontology and execution logic. It is the semantic equivalent of a state-machine transition -- `when the value is X, do Y.'"

25.5.4 Why `hasValue` Restrictions Matter for Execution

`hasValue` restrictions are essential for execution because:

1. **They bind properties to specific values.** Execution rules often depend on specific values, not general categories. The `hasValue` restriction is how OWL expresses this specificity.
2. **They enable precise triggers.** A trigger can be defined as "fire if the property has this specific value." Without `hasValue`, a trigger on `Spiciness` could fire on any spiciness -- `Hot`, `Medium`, or `Mild`. With `hasValue value Hot`, the trigger fires only on `Hot`.
3. **They compose with other constructs.** `hasValue` can be nested inside existential or universal restrictions, enabling complex conditions. The `SpicyPizza` definition -- `hasTopping some (hasSpiciness value Hot)` -- is a restriction inside a restriction. This composition is what makes the pattern expressive enough for real execution logic.
4. **They connect closed value domains to specific triggers.** In **Exercise 24**, we closed the value domain ("world") for `Spiciness`. In **Exercise 25**, we use that closed domain to bind specific triggers. The two constructs work as a team.

The table below contrasts the behavior of a property with and without `hasValue`:

Aspect	Without `hasValue`	With `hasValue`
Trigger condition	Fires on any value of the property	Fires on one specific value
Reasoner behavior	Cannot distinguish between values	Can distinguish specific values
Semantic strength	Description of a class of conditions	Specification of a specific condition
Execution readiness	Not executable for value-specific triggers	Executable for value-specific triggers

Key Insight:

> "Every semantic trigger is ultimately a `hasValue` restriction somewhere. The trigger fires when the property has the specific value that the trigger was designed to detect."

To see how `hasValue` becomes an execution rule, consider a simple trigger:

```
WHEN hasSpiciness value Hot
THEN trigger AlertSpicy
```

In the ontology, this trigger is expressed as a defined class or a query: "find all individuals whose `hasSpiciness` value is `Hot`." The reasoner computes the answer; the execution system reads it and fires the alert. The `hasValue` restriction is the semantic side; the alert is the operational side. Together, they form a **Θ-Trigger**.

This is why Chapter 24 called Stage 7 the layer of Θ (Trigger) and Φ (Execution). The ontology supplies the trigger condition; the runtime supplies the action.

25.5.5 Engineering Perspective: Exercise 25 as a Case Study

From the perspective of Protégé, **Exercise 25** involves creating a property, adding a restriction to a topping class, and defining a pizza class with a nested restriction. It appears to be moderate modeling activity.

From the perspective of ontology engineering, however, something important has occurred. The ontology now contains **value-based conditions** -- the semantic equivalent of conditional logic. The reasoner can fire on a specific value, not just a class of values.

The engineering contribution of **Exercise 25** can be summarized as follows:

Engineering Perspective	Contribution from Exercise 25
SKDL Stage	Stage 7 -- Executable Knowledge
Primary Objective	Introduce the `hasValue` restriction as a value-binding primitive
Modeling Activity	1. Create `hasSpiciness` property; 2. Add `hasSpiciness value Hot` to `JalapenoPepperTopping`; 3. Define `SpicyPizza` using `hasTopping some (hasSpiciness value Hot)`
Engineering Outcome	Enable value-based execution logic; the reasoner now classifies `AmericanaHotPizza` as a subclass of `SpicyPizza` by composing the value binding with the topping relationship
Preparation for Later Sections	Establish the value-binding foundation for the data-integrity logic in **Exercise 26** and the stage-level synthesis in **Chapter 26**

Key Insight:

> "**Exercise 25** is the moment the ontology gains the ability to express value-based conditions. This is the semantic foundation of triggers."

Following the Tutorial

Exercise 25 in the original `Pizza` Tutorial creates the `hasSpiciness` property with domain `PizzaTopping` and range `Spiciness`, adds the `hasSpiciness value Hot` restriction to `JalapenoPepperTopping`, and defines `SpicyPizza` as `hasTopping some (hasSpiciness value Hot)`, then converts it to a defined class and synchronizes the reasoner.

In this book, we have followed the tutorial's construction -- same property, same restriction, same defined class. The only difference is **presentational**: we have added the observation that this constitutes a *value-binding execution primitive*, and we have explicitly noted that the `value` keyword differs from `some` and `only` in binding a specific individual rather than a class of individuals.

The tutorial introduces the construct; the book frames it in terms of executability.

25.5.6 The Design Pattern Perspective

Exercise 25 completes the value layer of executability. Two design patterns are now in place:

- The **Enumerated Class** pattern -- closes a value domain by listing its complete extension.
- The `hasValue` **Restriction** pattern -- binds a property to one specific value from a closed domain.

These two patterns are designed to be used **together**, in a fixed order:

> **First close the domain, then bind the value.**
>
> For a property p whose permitted values are the finite set $V = \{v_1, v_2, \ldots, v_n\}$:
>
> 1. Define the value class as V (enumerated class).
> 2. Bind specific values with p value v_i (`hasValue` restriction).

The pattern is reusable because the problem it solves is universal. Any execution rule that fires on a specific value depends on both the *domain* being closed (so the rule knows all possible cases) and the *value* being bound (so the rule knows which case to fire on). Neither pattern alone is sufficient; the domain closure tells the rule what it must handle, and the value binding tells it what to fire on.

The Stage 7 pattern family now has four members:

Pattern	Purpose	Introduced
Probe Class	Detects membership through a discriminating marker	Chapter 22
Closure Axiom	Closes the world around a boundary	Chapter 24
Enumerated Class	Closes the value domain of a property	This chapter
`hasValue` **Restriction**	Binds a property to a specific value	This chapter

One more will join them in **Chapter 26** -- the **Cardinality Restriction** -- which closes the *number* of values a property may take, completing the boundary-value-integrity triad of Stage 7.

25.6 Chapter Summary

This chapter introduced the second part of **Stage 7 -- Executable Knowledge**: the **value layer**. Where Chapter 24 built the boundary layer (universal restrictions and closure axioms), Chapter 25 built the layer that binds specific values to properties and triggers.

The chapter established the value layer from two execution primitives:

Exercise 24 -- Enumerated Classes. We defined `Spiciness` as `EquivalentTo {Hot, Medium, Mild}`. This closed the *value domain* of the spiciness property: the reasoner now knows that `Hot`, `Medium`, and `Mild` are the *only* possible spiciness values. No other individuals can be spiciness values, because the enumeration is exhaustive.

Exercise 25 -- `hasValue` Restrictions. We created the `hasSpiciness` object property, bound `JalapenoPepperTopping` to `hasSpiciness value Hot`, and defined `SpicyPizza` as `hasTopping some (hasSpiciness value Hot)`. The reasoner then classified `AmericanaHotPizza` as a `SpicyPizza` -- automatically, without any explicit assertion that it is one. The `hasValue` restriction is the semantic foundation of the trigger: it binds a property to a specific value, and a specific value is what a trigger fires on.

The two primitives work as a pair. Enumeration closes the domain; `hasValue` binds the value. Neither alone is sufficient. Together, they enable **value-based execution logic** -- the ability to fire on *specific values* rather than *categories*.

We also extended the design-pattern thread. §25.3 named the OWL design-pattern concept and placed Stage 7's primitives in a family; §25.4.5, §25.5.5, and §25.5.6 recorded the two new patterns, enumerated class and `hasValue` restriction, alongside the closure axiom from Chapter 24 and the Probe Class from Chapter 22. The Stage 7 pattern family now has four members, and one more -- the cardinality restriction -- will join them in Chapter 26.

By the end of this chapter, you have:

- Understood why value specification is the second layer of executable knowledge
- Created a closed value domain with an enumerated class
- Bound a property to a specific individual with a `hasValue` restriction
- Defined a class using a nested restriction (`some` containing `value`)
- Observed the reasoner deriving a classification through composition
- Recognized the two new design patterns of the value layer

These capabilities prepare you for Chapter 26, which completes the executable ontology with cardinality restrictions for data integrity -- and consolidates the five primitives into a single anatomy of Stage 7.

Key Insight:

> "Enumeration closes the domain. `hasValue` binds the value. Together, they turn a class of possible values into a specific trigger."

25.7 Looking Ahead -- A Bridge to Chapter 26

The value layer of the executable ontology is now in place. We have learned:

- **How to close a value domain** using an enumerated class (`Spiciness = {Hot, Medium, Mild}`)
- **How to bind a property to a specific value** using a `hasValue` restriction
- **How to compose restrictions** to build value-based conditions (nested `some` / `value`)
- **How the reasoner derives classifications** through value composition

But the value layer, like the boundary layer before it, is only half the picture. A trigger that fires on a specific value is not yet a *complete* specification. To execute safely, the ontology must also guarantee that the required values are *present* -- that a property has at least one value, or at most one, or exactly one.

This is the subject of **Chapter 26**.

Chapter 26 introduces the final execution primitive:

> **Cardinality Restrictions (Exercise 26).**
> Cardinality restrictions constrain the *number* of values a property may take: `min`, `max`, and `exactly`. They complete the executable ontology by enforcing data completeness and integrity. Where the boundary layer closed *what* is permitted and the value layer bound *which value* fires, the cardinality layer guarantees *that the data required to fire is present*.

Chapter 26 also does more than introduce the last primitives. It consolidates the five primitives of Stage 7 into a single **anatomy of an executable ontology**, and examines executability from four complementary perspectives:

- **Mathematical** -- the logical foundations of closure, enumeration, binding, and cardinality
- **Historical** -- how the concept of executability evolved from expert systems to modern rule engines
- **Industrial** -- how executable ontologies are applied in manufacturing, compliance, and safety
- **EKA** -- how the five primitives map to the Θ (Trigger) and Φ (Execution) layers of the Executable Knowledge Architecture, and how that architecture bridges to the multi-layer model developed in **Chapter 27**.

The journey from boundary to value to integrity is the arc of Stage 7. Chapter 25 has established the second leg. Chapter 26 completes the journey -- and opens the door to the architectural synthesis that follows.

Key Insight:

> "A boundary tells the system what is permitted. A value tells the system what to act on. Cardinality tells the system when it has enough to act. Only all three together make execution safe."

Last updated at 2026-11-01